



EHL INSIGHTS REPORT

Hospitality Outlook 2026

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Foreword

Today, perhaps more than ever, the way we work is changing. Technological advancements, generational culture shifts and new customer and employee expectations are having a huge effect on hospitality. At EHL, we believe that successful businesses do not simply adapt to these changes but spearhead them.

As research by EHL faculty and industry experts shows, change presents both a challenge and an opportunity: to innovate and experiment, to create holistic systems that place people and planet at the center, and to harness new technologies to empower staff and guests. In other words, to reshape our workplaces for the better.

One such opportunity is presented by AI agents, the new frontier of artificial intelligence. These autonomous systems can anticipate needs, make decisions and execute complex tasks, freeing up staff to concentrate on what matters most in hospitality – the human touch.

Change is also afoot in food, as sustainability and technology drive a transformation in how food is sourced, prepared and experienced. The foodservice industry is in a unique position to lead this global shift towards more meaningful food experiences. Meanwhile, increasing consumer appetite for immersive travel experiences is generating creative new offerings that engage the senses and resonate emotionally.

Our relationship with sustainability is changing, too. Net zero is no longer enough; to really make an impact, companies must actively give back to their communities and ecosystems – a net positive approach that can be both purposeful and profitable.

At the heart of all this is the notion of human-centricity. As the industry faces an increasing labor shortage, human-centric leadership is more important than ever as we seek to make the workplace more attractive for employees and reshape hospitality to meet the challenges – and opportunities – of the future.

Markus Venzin
CEO, EHL GROUP

Facts & Figures

\$4.9 TRILLION

The global hospitality market grew from \$4.67 trillion to \$4.90 trillion in 2024 (Source: Hospitality Global Market Report 2024)

NOW

371 MILLION EMPLOYEES WORLDWIDE

The hospitality sector employs approximately 371 million people worldwide (Source: WTTC)

IN 10 YEARS

1 IN 8 JOBS GLOBALLY

Within the next decade hospitality jobs are expected to comprise one in eight jobs globally, totaling more than 460 million (Source: WTTC)

5.3% ESTIMATED ANNUAL MARKET GROWTH

Future projections estimate the market will grow at a compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 5.3% (Source: Hospitality Global Market Report 2024)

\$7,011.13 BILLION BY 2029

The projected growth of the global hospitality market is set to soar to \$7,011.13 billion by 2029 (Source: Hospitality Global Market Report 2024)

\$9.9 TRILLION IN TRAVEL SPENDING

Travel & Tourism contributed just over \$9.9 trillion to the global economy in 2023. In the next decade international visitor spending will reach about \$ 2.9 trillion (CAGR 3.4%) and domestic spending will grow to \$7.7 trillion with a CAGR of 3.3% (Source: WTTC)

10.3% OF WORLD'S ECONOMY

Travel & tourism contributes \$11.7 trillion to the global economy, accounting for 10.3% of global GDP (Source: WTTC)

AI Agents in Hospitality



Driving Innovation, Well-Being, and Personalized Guest Experiences

Artificial intelligence (AI) is everywhere nowadays. There is no conference or expert talk where AI does not take center stage. In the hospitality industry, the use of AI tools is gaining importance and gradually becoming a practical resource that, if used correctly, can support staff, improve operations, and enhance the well-being of both employees and guests.

The success of these tools depends not only on thorough staff training and integration into operational ecosystems but also on a clear intention: to use AI to empower employees rather than replace them. By taking this approach, the hospitality industry can harness AI-driven systems to reduce operational strain, free up staff for meaningful guest interactions, and create more resilient workplaces where people thrive – ultimately improving the guest experience.

The impact of AI on hospitality is already evident, even if widespread implementation is still developing. A survey of 327 hospitality professionals worldwide by [Canary Technologies on AI in Hospitality](#) found that 73% think AI will have a big impact on the industry. Some 61% of hoteliers said that AI is impacting the industry now or will within the next year, while 39% think it will impact hospitality in two or more years. Over 80% believe AI will significantly reshape pre-booking interactions and guest communications, enabling more personalized, seamless connections with customers.

Guests are also growing increasingly familiar with AI and are encountering more tools designed to enhance their travel experiences. According to the June 2025 [Skift US Travel Tracker Survey](#), which gathered responses from over 1,000 US travelers, more than half are using AI-based tools for travel planning.

In a survey of 86 primarily US-based travel executives, cited in the 2025 report [Remapping Travel with Agentic AI](#) from McKinsey & Company and Skift Research, 26% of respondents indicated that implementing AI reduced their operational costs, 30% said it sped up decision-making, and 33% reported improved customer personalization. In addition, 36% observed higher-quality outputs and 59% noted increased employee productivity. Overall, a majority of participants stated that AI adoption over the past three years had contributed to more than 6% annual revenue growth and the same percentage in annual cost savings.

AI IMPLEMENTATION IN HOSPITALITY STILL LIMITED

While the potential of AI in hospitality is significant, adoption remains relatively limited. A 2025 survey of 170 European hospitality businesses conducted by [HES-SO Valais](#) found that most AI applications in use today focus on real-time revenue management (42%), guest personalization (38%), and predictive analytics (37%). The analysis shows that most hotels currently focus on guest-facing tools that are easy to implement.



Among hotels already using AI, perceptions are notably positive. On a 1-10 scale, the average rating of AI's benefits by survey respondents was 6.6, with a median of 7. Nearly one in four hotels (23%) rated the benefits as 8 out of 10, and 14% gave the highest score. Only 5% reported seeing no benefit at all. Time savings (76%), improved communication (54%), and enhanced operational efficiency (51%) were most frequently mentioned as advantages. On the other hand, challenges include high implementation costs, technical complexity, and lack of technical skills. Data privacy issues and integration challenges are also significant, particularly for larger hotels with complex legacy systems. Research shows that AI is most effective when integrated into a broader digital strategy aligned with business goals, guest experience, and operational needs, which leads to enhanced efficiency without replacing the human touch that defines hospitality.

"In practice, this can look like using AI to optimize processes such as dynamic pricing or demand forecasting, but not to eliminate staff roles," says EHL Professor and tech expert Ian Millar. Instead, it should be used to complement human skills, providing staff with better tools, information, and support. "The lesson so far: AI can increase

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efficiency – but without reliable integration, careful training, and a focus on the needs of people, its impact and purpose remain limited,” Millar adds.



Ian Millar

EHL Senior Lecturer, expert on Entrepreneurship, Innovation and Hospitality Information Technology



Dr Reza Etemad-Sajadi

EHL Professor, expert on Customer Experience, CRM, Digital Transformation, AI, Human-Machine Interaction, Services Marketing, and International Strategy Management



Dr Jie Yu Kerguignas

EHL Assistant Professor, expert on Service Marketing, Transformative Marketing, and Technology-User Interaction

HOW AI CAN ENHANCE EMPLOYEE WELL-BEING

Beyond efficiency, AI can improve staff well-being – a growing priority in an industry associated with long hours, high turnover, and stress. EHL Professor Dr Reza Etemad-Sajadi, an expert on human-machine interaction, explains that AI can function as a “buffer” against burnout and workload imbalance. Predictive scheduling can anticipate peak stress periods and allocate staff effectively, while AI analytics can identify patterns of overworking or absenteeism, enabling proactive management.

AI can also support mental health by reducing repetitive tasks and enabling more balanced workloads. “When employees feel less overwhelmed by administrative burdens, they are better able to focus on the creative, social, and service-oriented aspects of their roles. These are factors strongly linked to job satisfaction,” says Dr Etemad-Sajadi.

Importantly, he emphasizes that AI must be implemented responsibly, with safeguards for privacy, data security and ethical considerations. “Used well, AI doesn’t just boost productivity, but can actively contribute to healthier, more sustainable workplaces.”

This dimension is particularly important as younger generations of workers increasingly look for employers who care about well-being and purpose. “In a competitive labor market, companies that use AI to create less stressful, more supportive environments may find themselves better positioned to attract and retain talent,” says Dr Etemad-Sajadi.

AI TOOLS SHOULD EMPOWER EMPLOYEES, NOT REPLACE THEM

Another advantage of AI tools is their ability to help staff manage problems that arise from increasing digitalization. A recent research project led by Dr Jie Yu Kerguignas at EHL and funded by HES-SO explores how the digitalization of services affects frontline employees’ productivity. Drawing on a panel of 262 hospitality professionals

and interviews with 10 hotel experts, the study found that system failures, complexity, and insufficient training undermine productivity and service quality.

Connectivity breakdowns, outdated software, and high training costs increase employee stress and can lead to guest dissatisfaction. “Hotel managers agree that technology is essential to modern operations, yet its shortcomings can quickly paralyze service delivery,” says Dr Yu Kerguignas.

Hotel managers consistently emphasize that technology is essential but must be reliable and aligned with operational needs. “Software that appears intuitive to IT experts can feel confusing and illogical for hospitality staff,” says Denis Wang, Administrator of Hôtel Beau Rivage Neuchâtel.



High investment in technology without guaranteed reliability can backfire, increasing stress rather than alleviating it. “This reflects a growing managerial concern: technology is indispensable, but only when it is both reliable and aligned with operational needs,” emphasizes Dr Yu Kerguignas.

AI AS A STRATEGIC ALLY

Against this backdrop, subsequent research by Dr Jie Yu Kerguignas reveals that most managers regard AI as a strategic ally, helping staff to manage technology and

overcome problems associated with it. “Today, AI enables greater personalization while also supporting staff – not to replace them, but to enhance their performance,” says General Manager of the Chalet RoyAlp Hôtel & Spa Egbert Buursink. Instead of removing jobs, AI can be used to predict system failures, reduce repetitive tasks, and serve as a digital assistant.

According to this study, the consensus among managers is that AI should operate quietly in the background, strengthening operations and boosting staff confidence while preserving the essential human element of hospitality. “The human being is at the heart of the matter. We must think about the benefit for the person,” says Nicolas Messian, Vice-President of Operations at Corner Collection.

To conclude, Dr Jie Yu Kerguignas notes: “The study clearly shows that hotel leaders are not afraid of AI. On the contrary, they are eager to experiment with tools that empower employees. The greatest demand is for AI solutions that increase productivity by predicting failures, simplifying workflows, and analyzing repetitive errors. And secondly, tools that support training and confidence through AI coaches, chatbots, and on-demand guidance.” It is also important to consider security, data protection, and cross-jurisdiction regulatory requirements, which remain major concerns for hotel groups and make AI adoption dependent on strong safeguards and increased compliance costs.

THE RISE OF AI AGENTS

Looking ahead, one of the most transformative innovations is the development of AI agents, whether in hospitality, healthcare, finance, or many other industries. In an interview in February 2025, Microsoft CEO Satya Nadella said that AI agents will reshape the landscape of Software as a Service (SaaS) businesses. These agents act as the primary interface between people and technology, responding to questions, executing tasks, retaining memory across interactions, and reshaping both enterprise and consumer computing.

In hospitality, AI agents are particularly relevant, representing the next step beyond traditional AI and Generative AI (GenAI).

AI agents can enhance guest experiences, streamline operations, and support data-driven decision-making. For example, by analyzing competitor pricing and market demand, AI agents can dynamically adjust room rates to optimize revenue and occupancy.

In a recent interview, Jeanelle Johnson, PwC’s travel, transportation and hospitality expert, said: “These are autonomous tools that make decisions in real time, whether that is curating a personalized guest offer or resolving an operational issue.”

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AGENTIC AI IN PRACTICE

The report Remapping Travel with Agentic AI from McKinsey & Company and Skift Research identified several ways in which agentic AI can significantly enhance hotel operations and property management by autonomously handling complex, real-time decisions:

Guest room allocation: Automatic assignment based on guest preferences, loyalty, and past feedback, saving 30 minutes to 2 hours per day for front-office staff.

Predictive maintenance: Anticipates issues, manages repairs, and orders parts autonomously, reducing rooms' out-of-service time by 20-30%.

Housekeeping management: Dynamically assigns tasks using real-time data, reducing hours by 10-30% and optimizing workflow.

Menu engineering: Analyzes offerings, pricing, and inventory, increasing net profit by 5-15%.

Unlike traditional chatbots, AI agents are proactive and capable of natural language interaction, system integration, and complex task execution. Florian Montag, EHL alumnus and VP at Apaleo, explains: "They anticipate needs, offer solutions, and adapt to context, reducing interruptions and letting staff focus on high-value interactions that define hospitality."

For hotels facing labor shortages, AI agents help maintain service quality, reduce staff pressure, and preserve organizational knowledge, which is increasingly valuable in a sector with high turnover. Hospitality tech expert Montag says that this is not about "robots replacing people" but about creating a collaborative dynamic where digital assistants handle routine complexity autonomously, freeing human employees to do what they do best: provide genuine hospitality.

EHL International Advisory Board (IAB) Member, investor and former CEO of Booking.com Gillian Tans sees AI agents as a game changer for the travel industry. "Generative AI will reshape travel by creating seamless, personalized journeys that anticipate traveler needs and remove friction. For hotels, it means transforming operations – from smarter demand forecasting to hyper-personalized guest experiences – unlocking new levels of efficiency and loyalty. Already today, agents make exploring destinations and planning activities simple and inspiring; the next leap is AI agents seamlessly moving from inspiration to action – such as booking your entire trip for you.

The rise of AI in hospitality demonstrates that technology can empower rather than replace human staff. AI agents can handle repetitive, data-driven, and complex tasks, allowing employees to focus on human-centricity and meaningful interactions. When implemented with careful training, integration, and ethical safeguards, AI becomes a tool to enhance workplace well-being, increase efficiency, and improve guest satisfaction, showing that a people-first approach and technological innovation can coexist, paving the way for a brighter future for our industry.

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Florian Montag

EHL alumnus, Vice President of the hospitality tech company Apaleo



Gillian Tans

EHL IAB Member, investor and former CEO of Booking.com

The Future of Food

THE FUTURE OF FOOD



From Sustainability in Foodservice to Tech Innovations in Food Production

Food is no longer just about nourishment, but has become a reflection of how we live, what we value, and where we are headed as a society. It is what connects us, sustains us, nourishes us, builds communities, keeps traditions alive and shapes our cultural identity. With so many trends emerging when it comes to gastronomy, nutrition, and well-being, the food industry is constantly transforming and reshaping itself. From health concerns to sustainability initiatives, from technological innovation to cultural identity, the way we produce, prepare, and consume food is undergoing profound changes.

The EHL Food & Well-Being 2025 report explored food as a multidimensional lever for well-being that goes beyond nourishment and engages health, purpose, culture, and planetary integrity. It explored key developments like the rise of the conscious consumer, the union of convenience and personalization, and the notion of co-responsibility across the food ecosystem.

It also showed that the hospitality industry is uniquely positioned to drive this shift, because foodservice touches so many lives every day. Hotels and restaurants can influence sourcing, design more health-conscious menus, promote social dining practices, and foster transparency and innovation in their operations. In doing so, they can support consumers' desire for food that is not just satisfying, but meaningful, regenerative, and aligned with both personal and planetary well-being.

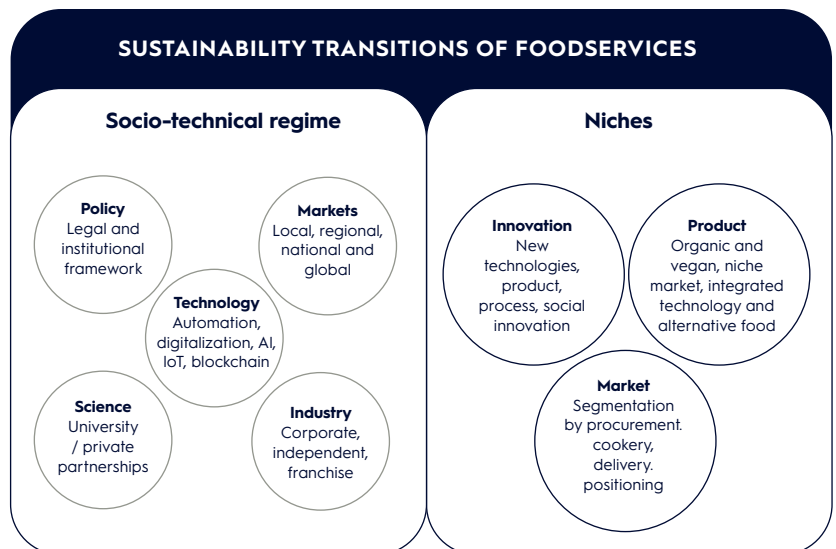
SUSTAINABILITY IN THE FOODSERVICE INDUSTRY

The foodservice industry is playing a particularly pivotal role in this movement, notably by balancing rising sustainability expectations with the need to remain

profitable and adaptable. A recent study from EHL, [Sustainability Transitions in the Swiss Foodservice: Re-imagining foodservice for a world never imagined \(STRest\)](#), examines how Swiss foodservice businesses are addressing this challenge by moving beyond incremental improvements toward fundamental reinvention.

Focusing on sustainability transitions and sustainable business model innovations, the project surveyed over 500 restaurants, hotels, caterers, and cafés on practices, barriers, and enablers across sourcing, waste, energy, and digitalization. The full results will be published and distributed globally through EHL's communications channels to industry, policymakers, and the wider public.

The research highlights the significant potential of foodservice businesses to drive systemic change across the food value chain, given their central role in shaping consumer habits, reducing food waste, and influencing sourcing practices. By combining ST theory with sustainable business model innovation (SBMI), the study explores how the sector can move toward more resilient and environmentally responsible practices.



The findings emphasize that small foodservice enterprises can adopt sustainability innovations ranging from waste reduction and circular practices (such as composting and closed-loop supply chains) to digital solutions for energy and resource efficiency. "Our findings show that sustainability innovations cut environmental impact and strengthen competitiveness, opening new revenue streams, improving efficiency, and winning sustainability-minded customers," says EHL Professor and author of the study Dr Carlos Martin-Rios. "To turn pilot schemes into everyday practice, businesses need three practical enablers: small-ticket finance for kitchen retrofits, procurement rules that reward waste and energy cuts, and supplier agreements for take-back and data-sharing," he adds.

For the industry, the key conclusion is clear: sustainability will become an increasingly decisive factor in business success. While the adoption of sustainable practices can be complex for smaller players, their role is vital for achieving broader climate and food system goals. "The study underscores the need for a balance between immediate operational needs and long-term environmental objectives, positioning sustainability not only as a moral imperative but also as a driver of competitiveness and resilience in the evolving foodservice landscape," says Dr Martin-Rios. He also emphasizes that food sustainability must move beyond being an elitist concept. "Sustainability should be widely accessible and affordable, not confined to premium

segments," he says. "Real progress happens when mainstream, high-volume operators build it into core operations, not as a niche add-on. When a chain-scale operator improves, impact multiplies across millions of meals. Fine dining, meanwhile, pilots ideas and shapes norms. We need both the scale and the spark."

RECONNECTING PEOPLE WITH HOW THEIR FOOD IS PRODUCED

Within the sustainability considerations, significant changes are also underway in how it is produced. Over the past four decades, consumers in industrialized countries have become increasingly detached from the origins of what they eat. Most food today is industrially manufactured, with numerous intermediaries standing between production and consumption. While industrialization has brought many benefits, such as improved life expectancy and reliable access to three meals a day, it has also created distance – both physical and psychological – between people and their food. Consequently, many feel a growing need to reconnect with food production. This desire for reconnection also reflects an increasing longing for authenticity, transparency, and more sustainable practices.

The conversation around production also highlights the growing rejection of processed foods: consumers are moving away from overly processed, industrial products and



Dr Carlos Martin-Rios
EHL Professor, expert on
Sustainability, Innovation and
Management



Dr Inès Blal
EHL Professor and Co-director of
the Institute for Nutrition R&D



Antonin Soussan
EHL Lecturer and Project
Manager of the Institute for
Nutrition R&D

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toward healthier, more authentic, cleaner, and sustainable options, as a report from the [Global Wellness Institute](#) shows. While the rise of plant-based foods remains important, demand is declining for heavily engineered alternatives packed with additives, sugar, or artificial flavors. Instead, there is increasing interest in functional foods, fermentation, and cooking methods that preserve both nutrients and taste.

With this in mind, the EHL Institute of Nutrition Research & Development has made it its mission to create delicious, sustainable, and nutritious food and beverage products. “We see that there are a lot of challenges in the current food system, and by leveraging our unique EHL expertise and know-how on gastronomy and business, we are helping to develop products that are healthy, sustainable, and tasty,” says Dr Inès Blal, EHL Professor and Co-director of the Institute for Nutrition R&D.

Together with industry partners, scientists, experts, and chefs, the institute works to reduce additives, replace artificial ingredients, and use advanced cooking and preservation methods, innovative techniques such as precise-temperature cooking, and processes that extend shelf life without chemical preservatives. “Our approach really shows how cross-disciplinary research can deliver healthier, more natural products that still meet the needs of today's markets,” says Dr Inès Blal.

HOW TECHNOLOGY IS TRANSFORMING FOOD PRODUCTION

Another successful result of cross-disciplinary research is the RoboCake project. Along with scientists from EPFL (the Swiss Federal Institute of Technology in Lausanne) and the Istituto Italiano di Tecnologia (IIT-Italian Institute of Technology), EHL pastry chefs and food scientists have created an edible robotic cake. “Though it is not a mainstream product, in the future edible robots could be used to deliver medicines in innovative ways to people who have difficulty swallowing or to deliver food to endangered areas,” explains Antonin Soussan, EHL Lecturer and Project Manager of the EHL Institute for Nutrition R&D.



RoboCake is just one – albeit niche – example of how advancements in technology are significantly transforming food production. Another is blockchain, which is proving particularly useful for quality control and traceability. “Blockchain technology offers enhanced transparency and traceability in the food supply chain, so consumers can trace back the ingredients to their source,” explains EHL Professor Dr Marc Stierand. By providing immutable records of each transaction, blockchain enables consumers and businesses to verify the origin, movement, and quality of food products in real-time. “This not only ensures food safety but also builds consumer trust by confirming the authenticity and sustainability of food items,”

says Dr Stierand, who for many years was a member of the executive board of the Swiss Food and Nutrition Valley.

The study Blockchain-Driven Food Supply Chains: A Systematic Review for Unexplored Opportunities from the University of Otago examined the diverse applications of blockchain technology in the food supply chain and identified further areas of innovation where it could be used in

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the future, such as food donation and redistribution, supply chain financing, animal welfare, and food waste management. What is more, the industry report State of Blockchain Transformation: Supply Chain from Settle Mint stated that 86% of supply chain leaders believe that the use of blockchain can offer a competitive advantage.

In parallel, innovative cooking technologies like sous-vide are revolutionizing food preparation methods. “Sous-vide, which involves cooking food in vacuum-sealed bags at precise temperatures, preserves nutrients and enhances flavors,” Dr Stierand says. This technique leads to healthier meals with improved taste and texture, aligning with the growing consumer demand for food that is both nutritious and delicious. In 2025, EHL's Dean of the School of Practical Arts Patrick Ogheard has co-authored the book *La Cuisson à Juste Température* (Hachette Pratique) about this method of cooking and the scientific transmission of taste.

EHL IAB Member Philipp Mosimann, Managing Director of Mosimann's Private Dining Club & Global Events, also sees great potential in linking technology with gastronomy: “Technology plays an increasingly vital and powerful role in shaping the future of food. It is remarkable how it can be applied across the entire journey – from farming, where it helps reduce waste and water use while improving crop yields, to the kitchen, where AI-driven menu planning enables chefs to optimize ingredients and significantly reduce food waste.” However, Mosimann notes that it should never be used as a replacement for people: “Technology should never replace the human touch. Food, at its core, is about people – their skill, intuition, and passion. The real opportunity lies in using technology to enhance that craftsmanship, allowing chefs and producers to focus on flavor, experience, and storytelling, while technology quietly manages the logistics and sustainability data behind the scenes.”

As these findings show, huge changes in food systems are already underway, driven by sustainability imperatives, consumer demand for authenticity, and the rise of new technologies. For the hospitality and foodservice industry, this represents both a challenge and an opportunity. By embracing these shifts the industry can be part of the transformation of not only what we eat, but of how food is sourced, prepared, and experienced. It is a collective journey in which every stakeholder – from farmers to chefs to consumers – plays a vital role in shaping a more sustainable and meaningful future for food.



Dr Marc Stierand
EHL Professor, expert of Culinary Creativity, Business Creativity and Aesthetic Leadership



Philipp Mosimann
EHL IAB Member and Managing Director of Mosimann's Private Dining Club & Global Events

A New Era A NEW ERA OF LEADERSHIP Leadership



Human-Centric Leadership as the Future of Work

Human-centricity and emotional intelligence are becoming increasingly important, especially with the rise of AI. With many employees seeking fulfillment and purpose in their jobs, human-centric values are becoming key to ensuring an attractive, healthy, sustainable, and happy workplace.

When placed at the core of hospitality, human-centricity influences not only the guest relationship but also the employee relationship, creating a more modern work environment that helps employers attract and retain talent. With the hospitality industry currently facing extreme challenges due to labor shortages, this shift in leadership style is essential. Particularly because the sector is booming: the hotel and tourism industry is expected to grow immensely in the coming years, with the number of travelers set to increase globally. According to the [World Travel & Tourism Council](#) the sector currently accounts for 10.3% of global GDP. Within the coming years the global hospitality market is expected to reach \$7,011.13 billion, with an estimated compound annual growth rate (CAGR) of 5.3%. While there are presently around 371 million hospitality employees worldwide, the sector is expected to require more than 460 million within the next decade.

However, many surveys and studies show that the industry is facing issues finding employees for vacant positions. For example, a survey by the [American Hotel & Lodging Association \(AHLA\)](#) showed that 65% of hotels report staff shortages. Even though many hotels seem to have improved their incentives – such as offering higher pay and flexible working hours – hotel employment is still nearly 10% below pre-pandemic staffing levels. Of the hoteliers surveyed by AHLA, 47% said that their most frequently used strategy for attracting and retaining workers was offering higher wages, while 20% were offering flexible working hours, 13% reported providing hotel

discounts, and 9% were participating in job fairs and advertising.

With not enough staff, it is difficult to maintain and continue operations as usual, which can result in a decline in service quality, a reduced range of services, and lower revenues. A 2022 survey of the Swiss industry association [HotellerieSuisse](#) showed that due to labor shortages around 60% of the businesses surveyed were having to make adjustments to their offerings, while those experiencing recruitment difficulties reported an average loss of revenue of 4%.

Therefore, in order to ensure sufficient skilled workers for the rapidly growing market in the future, it is essential for the hospitality industry to not only reinvent itself when it comes to more flexible working models – as discussed in [New Working Models: A Blueprint for Professional Well-being through Modernization and Talent Management](#), part of [EHL's Hospitality Outlook 2025](#) report – but also to create a more appealing work environment by nurturing human-centricity in leadership. This approach can inspire a whole new work culture that not only puts the needs of its guests at the center of its operations, but also the needs of its employees.

QUALITIES OF A HUMAN-CENTRIC LEADER

Emotional intelligence – or so called “soft skills” – builds the foundation of human-centric leadership. Findings from the research and advisory company [Gartner](#) identified three key qualities of a human-centric leader: **authenticity**, which allows for true self-expression and acting with purpose; **empathy**, which means having genuine care for the needs and well-being of workers; and **flexibility**, meaning having the desire to adapt working conditions to meet the needs of employees.

EHL Professor Dr Sébastien Fernandez says that an authentic leader needs to first and foremost know themselves. “Authenticity starts with self-awareness,” he says, adding that the ability to be honest and transparent is also essential. “Communicating mistakes, your own weaknesses and doubts is important when adopting this leadership style.”

In a 2022 survey by the Boston Consulting Group participants noted other characteristics of human-centric leaders, such as consideration, listening skills, team development, self-reflection and transparency.

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A HAPPY WORKFORCE FOR A HEALTHY BUSINESS

In today's workplace, employees' priorities have evolved profoundly, accelerated by the pandemic and shaped by the expectations of younger generations who seek purpose, well-being, and ethical leadership over mere stability. As a result, human-centric leadership has become a key differentiator for organizations aiming to attract and retain talent. According to the Gartner research, employees with human-centric leaders are 37% more engaged, and highly engaged teams perform 27% better.

Another study from the [University of Warwick](#) found that happy employees are 12% more productive, showing the direct link between well-being and performance. Data reveals that 83% of employees value well-being as much as salary, while 77% would leave a company that neglects the well-being of their employees.

Adopting human-centric leadership enhances creativity and innovation by fostering psychological safety, encouraging open dialogue and experimentation without fear of failure. Ultimately, this leadership style nurtures a healthier, more authentic workplace culture grounded in trust, empathy, and transparent communication, aligning personal motivation with organizational purpose.

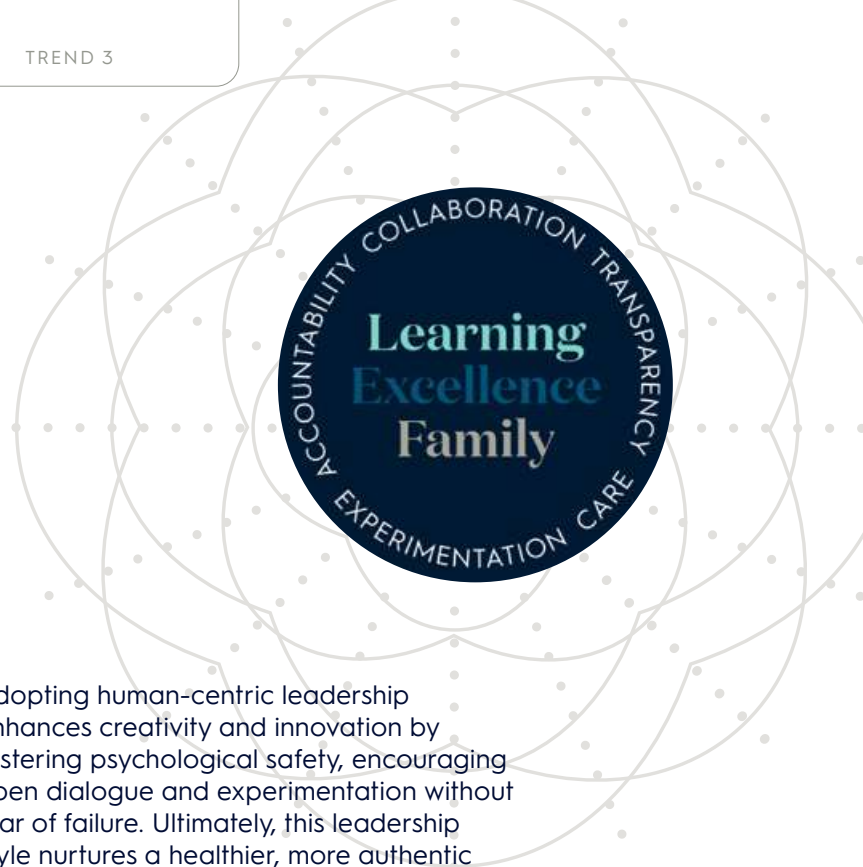
At EHL, a new leadership model was introduced in 2023. Designed by and for the EHL community, the EHL Tempo initiative is built on the three values EHL stands for – Learning, Family and Excellence – and comprises five key leadership principles and behaviors: Transparency, Experimentation, Collaboration, Care and Accountability. As Prof. Markus Venzin, CEO of EHL group, says: “Shaping EHL's culture means using our Tempo leadership principles to positively impact our working environment and culture, ensuring that we can provide a meaningful experience for the EHL community.”



Dr Sébastien Fernandez
EHL Associate Professor of
Organizational Behavior



Prof. Markus Venzin
CEO, EHL GROUP



HUMAN-CENTRIC LEADERSHIP IS A PRIORITY FOR GEN Z

Although human-centricity is essential for people of any age, Gen-Z employees consider it especially important. A 2025 Deloitte Gen Z & Millennial Survey showed that younger generations are redefining success and prioritizing learning, well-being, and purpose over traditional career advancement. Only 6% of respondents see leadership roles as their top ambition, while 70% of Gen Z and 59% of millennials regularly develop new skills outside work. They value soft skills such as empathy and communication more than purely technical expertise. For these generations, human-centric leadership matters: 86% say mentorship, empathy, and purpose-driven management are essential to a positive work experience.

EHL Professor Dr Stefano Borzillo recently conducted research with the University of Applied Sciences HES-SO on the subject Ensuring a Pipeline of Gen-Z Talent for the Hotel Industry: Contrasting Views of Hoteliers and Future Graduates. The study, which investigates the perceptions of hospitality students and hotel general managers regarding the hospitality industry's efforts to attract and retain Gen-Z talent, found that human-centric leadership is an essential topic for Gen-Zers. "The Gen-Z hospitality students we surveyed emphasized the need for flatter hierarchies, transversal collaboration, and project-

based work, while hotel GMs acknowledged the importance of moving away from rigid structures," says Dr Borzillo. "Students also expressed concern over toxic cultures, harassment, and the issue of 'greenwashing', calling instead for authentic leadership and a visible commitment to diversity, inclusion, and Corporate Social Responsibility (CSR)."

Literature shows that recruiters should design jobs for Gen-Zers that emphasize autonomy and achievement while making them feel safe, and that aligning a hotel's CSR initiatives with Gen-Z values fosters a sense of fit and trust, which is crucial for attracting and retaining talent. Furthermore, hospitality students' satisfaction with internships impacts their intention to pursue a career in the industry, with factors such as relationships with colleagues and managers, skills gained, relevance and integration of coursework, quality of guidance and feedback from supervisors, and the structure and organization of the internship playing significant roles.

Transparency and fairness are also key components for retaining Gen-Z talent, according to the EHL and HES-SO study. "They expect clear career progression paths, transparent promotion criteria, and fair reward systems, which they see as essential for building trust," says Dr Borzillo. The study also showed that they value employers who demonstrate care for employee well-being, flexible schedules, and mental health support.



Dr Stefano Borzillo
EHL Associate Professor of
Organizational Behavior



Dr Bertrand Audrin
EHL Assistant Professor for Human
Resource Management and
Organizational Behavior



Frank Marrenbach
EHL IAB Member and CEO of
Althoff Hotels

"Hospitality organizations are required to further break down organizational silos to stimulate collaborative exchanges of knowledge and best practices," Dr Borzillo explains. Also important to Gen-Z is feedback culture and increased interaction across hierarchies, he adds. "Looking back at their internships, the surveyed students regretted their scarce interaction with management. Regular interaction and feedback has a positive impact on employees, especially when starting out in a career." Nurturing human interaction is, therefore, a key way to make the hotel industry attractive to Gen-Z.

HUMAN-CENTRICITY AT ANY AGE AND ANY LEVEL

However, adopting a more human-centric leadership culture is not only beneficial for the new and future workforce, but for employees and leaders of any generation. EHL Professor Dr Bertrand Audrin says that the business world and industry should not differentiate too strongly between the specific needs of different generations. "Often times we use generations as stereotypes, and unfortunately, there have been a lot of labels put on Gen-Z in the business world. This is merely due to the fact that the younger generations are challenging the status quo and want to see society progress by creating a better work culture for the future, where purpose and well-being matter."

Dr Audrin also emphasizes that leadership, at its core, is defined not by titles, but by how it is perceived and received by the team, "because it is the team that ultimately decides whether a leader is successful."

True leadership, then, depends on building an environment where people feel empowered to share ideas and challenge perspectives. Creating such a team requires intentional effort: choosing the right people, cultivating psychological safety, and maintaining a healthy flow within the group. "A team is an ecosystem that a human-centric leader must nurture continuously."

In this way, human-centricity is relevant to every employee, no matter their age or profession – and therefore essential for every future leader to master. For Frank Marrenbach, EHL IAB Member and CEO of Althoff Hotels, leadership is one of the most important subjects when it comes to the future

of hospitality. "Leadership is what differentiates good companies from great companies," he says, adding that human-centricity should be a core competence that is taught early. "The future hospitality leader needs to have the ability to comprehend the human mind, the willingness to dive into the complexity of people, and also the curiosity which is paired with it. And of course, good soft skills. To be able to listen proactively but also form an opinion and at the same time not be opinionated – I see that as a very important skill."

“*The future hospitality leader needs to have the ability to comprehend the human mind, the willingness to dive into the complexity of people, and also the curiosity which is paired with it.*”

Marrenbach also states resilience and empathy as key competences of a human-centric leader. "Our world is very complex, so our leaders need to be resilient, meaning they can stay strong and maintain the right energy level at all times. Being able to turn things and situations into something positive and productive, all while being empathetic and caring towards other people, is essential."

In conclusion, human-centricity represents not just a management trend, but a necessary evolution in how organizations approach people, culture, and performance. As the industry faces labor shortages, shifting employee values, and accelerating technological change, it is essential to create work environments that foster well-being, purpose and collaboration and to train people who can lead with empathy, self-awareness, and authenticity. With these values at heart, human-centric leadership can create an attractive workplace for many generations to come, improving the satisfaction of not only its employees, but also its guests and communities.

Immersive Experience Hospitality



Hospitality Leading the Immersive Experience Economy

The hospitality industry has been leading the experience economy for decades. After the agricultural and industrial revolution came the development of the service industry, followed by the emergence of a fourth economic driver: the experience economy. Today, the experience economy is evolving, with demand rising for not just memorable experiences but truly immersive ones – a shift that hospitality organizations are uniquely positioned to embrace.

Traditionally, economists have categorized experiences together with services, yet experiences represent a distinct form of economic value. These days, it is clear that experiences stand on their own as a separate offering, driven by consumers' growing desire for memorable, meaningful encounters and by the increased focus of businesses on designing and promoting experiences to meet that demand.

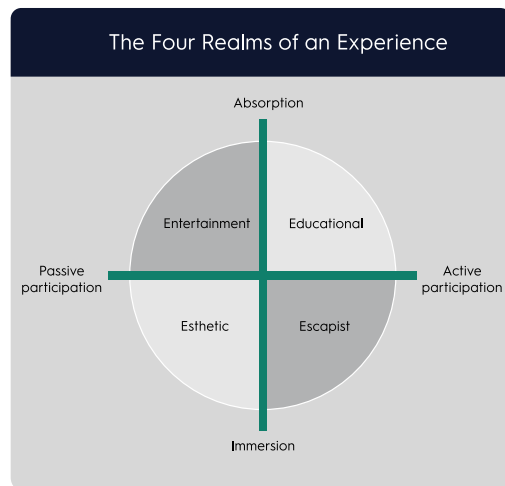
For the hospitality industry this represents huge potential for growth. As studies including the [Julius Baer Lifestyle survey](#) show, people prefer to indulge in experiences rather than products. According to the [Bain Altagamma study](#), experiences showed the strongest spending growth in 2024, as consumers prioritized travel, social events, and wellness-focused activities over traditional consumption.

THE FOUR REALMS OF THE EXPERIENCE ECONOMY

As the [Harvard Business Review](#) states, an experience is not an abstract concept, but a tangible economic offering, just like a service, a good, or a commodity. In today's service-driven economy, many companies enhance their traditional products by surrounding them with experiences to make them more appealing. However, to fully capture the value of experiences, businesses

must go beyond that and intentionally design immersive, engaging experiences that customers are willing to pay for.

According to [Pine and Gilmore's "Experience Economy" framework](#), all experiences can be categorized into four realms that interact with two dimensions: the customer's level of participation and the extent of their connection with their surroundings. The first dimension ranges from **passive participation**, where the customer is an observer (as in watching a concert or play), to **active participation**, where the customer directly contributes to the event (such as skiing or performing in a play). The second dimension stretches from **absorption**, where individuals take in an experience from a distance (like viewing a film), to **immersion**, where they become fully enveloped in the environment (as in a virtual reality simulation).



Source: Harvard Business Review

Experiences can then be divided into four realms, each with its own relationship to the two dimensions: **Entertainment** (passive and absorbing), **Education** (active and absorbing), **Escapism** (active and immersive), and **Esthetic** (passive and immersive). The most compelling experiences combine elements of all four, creating a "sweet spot" that fully engages guests on cognitive, emotional, and sensory levels.

As EHL Assistant Professor Dr Valentina Clergue emphasizes, the experience economy is hardly a new concept for hospitality. The industry has, in many ways, embodied it for decades. What is evolving, however, is the shift from passive to transformative experiences. “In the past, guests might have been content with passive enjoyment, such as attending a concert, but now they seek active participation and co-creation, for example by taking part in a cooking class or an immersive dining event. We are moving towards a more holistic form of experiential marketing and consumption, where immersion provides an escape from daily routines and creates emotional connections that last far beyond the moment itself.”

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She adds: “The hospitality industry has been naturally and continuously working to enhance the guest experience. With more offers and services available, the needs and desires of people have also shifted, leading them to seek deeper and more meaningful experiences in which they can fully immerse themselves.”

What makes this so special in the hospitality industry is the human component, explains Dr Clergue. “In hospitality, you have not only the physical environment but also the human connection. In an art gallery, you might not need a person to greet or serve you, but in hospitality, it is about human interaction.”

HUMAN CONNECTION IS WHAT MAKES HOSPITALITY STAND OUT

With the guest and their needs and desires at the center of an experience, the hospitality industry is uniquely positioned to harness the full potential that lies in the emerging immersive experience economy. “The hospitality industry’s DNA is rooted in hosting, entertaining and, quintessentially, an exchange based on human interaction. It also comes down to the concept of ‘Hospitality Vibes’, which refers to the positive energy created by humans and spaces,” says EHL Associate Professor Dr Meng-Mei Maggie Chen.

This human- and guest-centric focus is also one of the reasons why companies from luxury, healthcare, and other industries are collaborating with hospitality organizations



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in order to upscale guest experiences. For example, Tesla opening a diner with a drive-in theater in Los Angeles, Ralph Lauren launching a café in Kuala Lumpur, and Bulgari opening hotels in cities around the world.

When designing immersive experiences, there are no limits when it comes to creativity. A variety of tools and elements can be used, including gamification, which refers to the application of game-design elements and game principles in non-game contexts – an effective way to enhance guest engagement. Another tool is storytelling, for example embedding products within a narrative and experiential framework.

A prime example of an immersive experience is a pop-up in New York by the French luxury fashion house Hermès, which transformed an event space into an elaborate crime scene, offering guests an intriguing murder mystery experience. “The luxury brand has used gamification and storytelling in order to create a unique, memorable and immersive experience for their customers,” says Dr Chen.

PLAYING WITH THE SENSES AND THE ROLE OF TECHNOLOGY

Brands can also make use of sensory elements that appeal to all five senses – touch, sight, hearing, smell and taste – by using light, scent, texture and sound to deepen emotional connections. Rooted in the concept of sensory marketing, these experiences engage the senses to create memorable and emotionally resonant encounters rather than merely functional services.

“Engaging the senses is key when creating memorable experiences. The more senses an experience stimulates, the deeper and more lasting its impact becomes, because sensory cues enrich the experience beyond the functional act itself and activate multiple senses to evoke emotion and immersion,” says Dr Chen.

For instance, travelers instantly recognize Bombay Sapphire in airport duty-free shops thanks to its signature blue bottle. Even those without a Netflix subscription can identify the platform by its iconic opening sound. Visitors to Japan often remember the comforting warmth of a Japanese toilet seat long after

their trip. Similarly, the familiar scent of Ivory soap or Johnson’s baby shampoo can transport people back to their childhood, evoking deep, nostalgic emotions.

Technology is also accelerating the experience economy in hospitality by enabling new forms of engagement

“
The luxury brand has used gamification and storytelling in order to create a unique, memorable and immersive experience for their customers
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and immersion. Examples of immersive restaurants such as Le Petit Chef or Copenhagen’s Alchemist show how projection mapping, storytelling, and sensory design can turn a meal into a multisensory journey.

Virtual and augmented reality are likewise reshaping hospitality experiences. VR lets guests explore hotels and destinations remotely, enhancing the booking process, while AR enriches on-site stays with interactive features such as digital menus or local insights. Restaurants use interactive displays for ordering and engagement, and hotels offer personalized in-room entertainment. Many brands now combine these tools to create immersive, story-driven experiences that make visits more memorable and emotionally engaging.

It is not necessary to have a huge budget to turn an experience into an immersive experience, emphasizes Dr Chen. “There are many niche opportunities for all types of businesses, whether big or small, to help people reconnect to real life and real human interaction by weaving the experiential into the offer. For example, a laundromat in the Netherlands has turned its business into a place for sharing food, meeting people and hosting parties,” she says.

LIVE EVENTS AND BRANDED LUXURY EVENTS

Live events are increasingly shaping travel decisions, with travelers seeking experiences that go beyond sightseeing. Data shows that people often attend events not just for the act itself, but to enrich their travel memories. Iconic venues like the Sphere in Las Vegas or the Red Rocks Amphitheatre in Colorado illustrate this trend. Guests may see a band they have never heard of simply for the thrill of experiencing a concert in a unique setting.

Aside from live events, EHL Assistant Professor Dr Matthias Fuchs also points to a possible rise in branded luxury life events. In recent years the events industry has seen a shift to so-called micro-events, smaller-scale gatherings designed to foster deeper connections and engagement among participants. "Notably there has been an increase in couples opting for smaller weddings with more personalized touches that reflect their unique personalities," Dr Fuchs explains.

For example, Audemars Piguet's AP Houses are luxurious, exclusive spaces that reflect the brand's sophistication and elegance. "These venues in prestigious cities allow VIP customers to celebrate their birthdays, enjoying personalized and memorable experiences in a refined setting." Dr Fuchs believes this could expand even further as customer demand increases. "While not a reality yet, one could also imagine bespoke weddings organized by a luxury brand such as Dior. From custom-designed dresses to branded event decor, Dior, just

like other luxury brands, has the potential to ensure that these milestone celebrations are infused with their vision of luxury, sophistication and personalization, creating an immersive and memorable experience for guests while also enhancing brand loyalty."

A study from [McKinsey](#) shows that customer loyalty is driven less by the product and more by an experience worth paying for. Hospitality brands and travel providers can capitalize on this by curating distinctive, memorable experiences with or without collaborating with neighboring industries such as luxury brands or the healthcare industry. In a landscape of expanding options, restaurants, hotels, and other travel touchpoints can build on this momentum to craft meaningful moments that resonate with travelers and make their stays unforgettable.

"Immersive experiences have become so important and popular because the expectations of our guests and travelers from all over the world have become much more sophisticated in the last few years," says Christoph Hoffmann, EHL IAB Member and Founder of 25hours Hotels and Bikini Island & Mountain Hotels."

Hoffmann has developed individual, tailor-made hotels with personality in cities worldwide. Each 25hours property is unique, with a playful design inspired by its location and influenced by the art, culture, gastronomy, and stories of its surroundings. "We have dived into high-level individual experiences by using storytelling and design. We really built the style of our hotels not with the idea to merely create an aesthetic design, but to create an experience for our guests and asking the important questions of what the added value is when staying at a 25hours hotel.

As the boundaries between hospitality and other industries continue to blur, the immersive experience economy offers boundless opportunities for innovation and growth. By embracing creativity, technology, and personalization, the hospitality industry can continue to lead the way and spearhead the immersive experience economy into its next chapter and beyond.

Christoph Hoffmann
IAB Member and
Founder of 25 hours
Hotels and Bikini Island
& Mountain Hotels



Regenerative Hospitality



Embedding People, Place, and Planet

Sustainability has long been an important issue for the hospitality industry. Environmental initiatives, regulations to reduce greenhouse gases, and increasingly scarce resources such as water have provoked a rethink among businesses, guests, and consumers alike. Consumer interest in eco-tourism, sustainable practices, and green travel has grown, while such options have also become more accessible and affordable. A study from the [Business & Economics School ISG in Portugal](#) shows that hotels that are perceived as more sustainable enjoy higher guest loyalty, while a study from the [Northeastern Agricultural and Resource Economics Association](#) finds that consumers are even willing to pay a surcharge (~6%) on restaurant bills for carbon emission reduction programs.

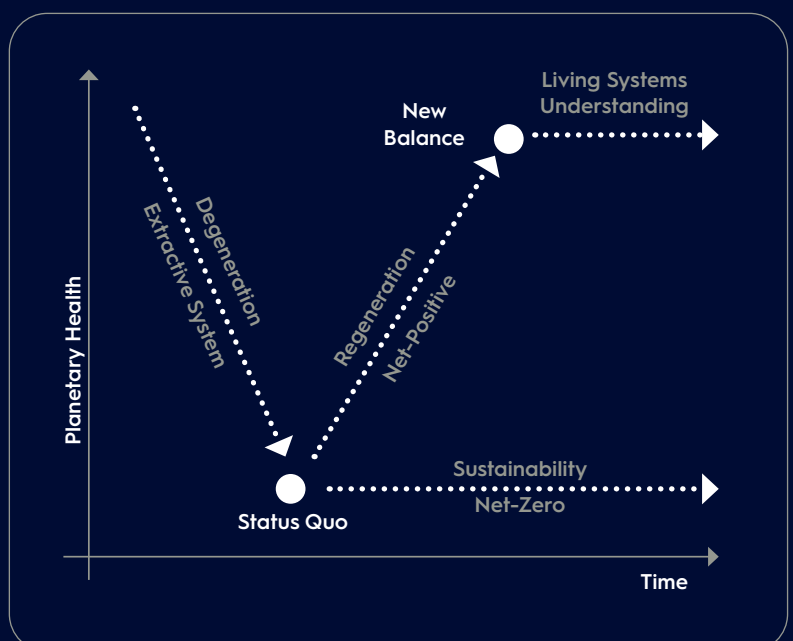
However, whereas for many years striving for a net-zero impact has been the guiding principle in the industry, a growing body of research and practice suggests that “doing less harm” is no longer enough. In fact, studies now show that guests increasingly expect *more* than sustainability.

Enter **regenerative hospitality**, a mindset shift from **net-zero** to **net-positive**, which aims to actively restore ecosystems, strengthen communities, and create net-positive outcomes **for people and places**. Where sustainability measures success by what is reduced or avoided – less carbon, less water, less waste – regeneration, in contrast, focuses on what is given back. Not only that, but at its core, regenerative hospitality applies the logic of **interconnected living systems**: the idea that everything around us can be understood as part of a living system – whether, social, relational, economic or ecological – and that all these different systems are deeply interconnected, meaning that a change in any given system (i.e. the social system) will have an effect on another (i.e. the ecological system). A hotel, for example, is not an isolated business, but is connected to its surroundings, the natural landscape, local food producers, cultural traditions, and the well-being of guests, staff and community.

As EHL Professor Dr. Alessandro Inversini, co-author of the study **The Rise of Regenerative Hospitality**, explains, “regenerative economics starts from interconnectedness. Hotels are not single entities; they are embedded in a community and an environment. Regeneration is about making that connection visible, tangible, and positive for all.”

Another recent study, *Assessment of Regenerative Hospitality*, from the Stenden University of Applied Sciences, identifies seven pillars – regenerative mindset, interconnectedness, place integration, localized impact, well-being, co-creation, and dynamism – as potential drivers of regenerative hospitality.

For some hotels, a regenerative practice could mean developing an ecological restoration program: replanting mangroves, supporting biodiversity, or rewilding land. For others, it could mean social regeneration: creating spaces where local artists can perform, providing training for local groups, or hosting innovation hubs that connect residents. In both cases, the aim is not just to offset harm but to create tangible new value.



FOCUS ON PEOPLE AND PLACE

Sustainability efforts often focus on environmental concerns and sometimes tend to overlook broader systemic issues such as social inequality, economic structures, and cultural dynamics. Sustainability claims are often prone to greenwashing. The scale of today's global crises, such as climate change, systemic injustice, and geopolitical instability, demands more than localized, incremental solutions – it calls for a coordinated, systemic and structural transformation.

Responding to this need, EHL Hospitality Business School, together with the Swiss university HES-SO Valais, has developed the [*Regenerative Hospitality Canva: A Transformative Playbook*](#) to help hoteliers move from net-zero to net-positive and create lasting value for both communities and guests. Developed with key industry partners, the playbook provides hotel managers with a clear methodology to identify net-positive contributions and turn them into concrete actions.

The playbook draws on the two core concepts of regenerative hospitality: the **regenerative mindshift**, which cultivates leaders' awareness of their ecological and social responsibilities, and the **ecosystem approach**, which integrates natural environments and human relationships to drive transformation.

Key elements of this model include **place intelligence**, which addresses the social and natural ecosystems of a location, and **people intelligence**, which focuses on transformative host-guest interactions. This holistic approach is applicable to hospitality businesses of all sizes and types, showing that regeneration is not just an ideal but a financially viable, strategically designed and purpose-driven business model that can lead to long-term, positive impacts.

"Regenerative hospitality embodies a broader responsibility towards the reality and ecosystems, which is both **place-based** and **people-centered**," explains Dr Inversini, who spearheaded the research and has written a book about the subject, *Regenerative Hospitality, Strategies for Transformative Hospitality Leaders*, edited by Edgar Elgar Publishing.

WHY REGENERATION MATTERS FOR HOSPITALITY

Hospitality is uniquely positioned to lead this shift because of its dependence on both **people** and **place**. Unlike other industries, hotels and resorts cannot "outsource" their environment: a beachfront property is inseparable from the health of its coastline; a mountain lodge from the surrounding ecosystem; a city hotel from its neighborhood's social fabric.

Regeneration can offer operational resilience, prompting hotels to reconsider supply chains, community relations, and environmental dependencies. These shifts can reduce risk, differentiate brands, and open new sources of value that go beyond cost control.

Many concrete examples of regenerative practices in hospitality and tourism have already emerged. For example, the eco-luxury resort Playa Viva in Mexico restores

“
Regenerative hospitality embodies a broader responsibility towards the reality and ecosystems, which is both place-based and people-centered.
”



Dr Alessandro Inversini
EHL Professor, expert on Digital Communication, Digital Marketing, E-tourism, Digital Transformation, Mobile Marketing and Regenerative Economics

coastal ecosystems and invests in local health and education, the Fogo Island Inn in Canada blends ecological stewardship with guest engagement, and the Brazilian Ibiti Projeto, which was a keynote speaker on regenerative economies at the 2025 EHL Open Innovation Summit, has transformed degraded areas into a 6,000-hectare biodiversity refuge and reintroduced native species into the ecosystem.

In Switzerland, the *Regenerative Hospitality Canva: A Transformative Playbook* has been tested with key industry players including Geneva Marriott Hotel, Hilton Geneva, Six Senses Crans Montana, and Hôtel des Horlogers, each adapting regenerative practices to their unique local contexts and testing out the practicality and adaptability of the approach.

“For us, regenerative hospitality goes beyond sustainability. It is about actively creating a positive impact on our environment, our community, and our guests’ well-being. At Geneva Marriott Hotel, this means rethinking hospitality in a way that restores, nurtures, and regenerates the ecosystem we are part of, while ensuring a meaningful and responsible guest experience,” says Pierre-Henri Perrin, General Manager of Geneva Marriott Hotel. The hotel has implemented several initiatives, including local sourcing and partnerships with regional producers to support surrounding communities and short supply chains, waste reduction programs, and collaborations with impactful locals who share the same vision for a more responsible future. “We believe regenerative hospitality will become a

defining pillar of the hospitality industry,” adds Perrin. “Guests will increasingly expect hotels not only to minimize harm but to actively regenerate local ecosystems and communities. In the future, this will translate into deeper collaborations with local producers, more transparent measurement of impact, and the integration of wellness, culture, and nature into the essence of the guest journey.”

Other pioneers include the Six Senses in Crans Montana, where wellness and regenerative design have been at the core of the brand since its establishment in 1995. “Regenerative hospitality is an ambitious journey, not a destination,” says Dominic Paul Dubois, Sustainability Director of Six Senses Crans Montana.

Long committed to sustainable practices and eco-responsible standards, the Hôtel des Horlogers in the Vallée de Joux has also embraced regeneration as part of its identity. “Regeneration is embedded in our hotel’s DNA. Just like the watchmakers in the region, we do more than we say. The process is complete and holistic. It forces you to think about aspects that otherwise would not have been considered,” says André Cheminade, General Manager at Hôtel des Horlogers.

To further its understanding of the subject, EHL is currently leading a research project in rural Lebanon, together with the Nature Conservation Centre of the American University of Beirut, to better comprehend the role of regenerative hospitality and the use of digital technologies to support natural and social systems regeneration.



Pierre-Henri Perrin
General Manager of Geneva
Marriott Hotel



Dominic Paul Dubois
Six Senses Crans Montana
Sustainability Director



André Cheminade
General Manager at Hôtel des
Horlogers

THE PATH FORWARD

While regenerative hospitality is still in its early stages, some hoteliers remain cautious. The lack of standardized metrics makes measurement difficult. Several industry and standard-setting bodies – including the [Global Sustainable Tourism Council \(GSTC\)](#), [UNESCO's Travel Pledge](#), [World Sustainable Hospitality Alliance](#) or the [Forbes Travel Guide](#) – are now developing clearer frameworks and best practices to ensure sustainability claims become more verifiable. While there are not yet strictly defined metrics for regeneration, many experts agree that real impact is measured at the level of community ecosystems, for example through community well-being, nature restoration, or local culture preservation.

As Professor Dr Inversini says, “Regeneration is not a recipe – it is a process of listening, trying, failing, and learning. Regenerative professionals do not intend to introduce new regenerative metrics or propose specific measurements or scales. There are no checklists to adhere to; there are no standards whatsoever. Rather, the impact of regeneration is visible by the hotel staff and their guests, because regeneration is systemic yet local, and its ripple effect can be seen in the restoration, enhancement and co-evolution of the local ecosystems.”

Another challenge is the contextual nature of regeneration, which means that no two approaches look the same. What works for a city business hotel may not translate to a mountain lodge. Yet these very challenges open space for innovation. By moving beyond top-down prescriptions and instead engaging with local needs, regenerative hospitality can avoid the pitfalls of one-size-fits-all approaches.

Vivian Wei Zhou, EHL International Advisory Board (IAB) Member and Vice President of the tourism and hospitality company Jin Jiang International in Shanghai, believes in the potential of regenerative economics and its importance for the future of humanity. “I believe the approach of regenerative economics goes beyond sustainability, as it reminds us how we should cherish the Earth and all the resources it gives us.” However, it’s important to make it applicable to profit-oriented businesses and to take a collaborative approach, she adds. “It requires coordination from all the stakeholders

as it is a joint effort, taking into account the technological dimension, the business dimension, as well as policies and cross border compliance.”

It is also important to emphasize that regenerative hospitality should not be viewed as a new sustainability standard or a substitute for sustainable practices. Rather, it should be approached as an additional way to align more closely with nature, community and humanity as a whole. “Regenerative hospitality should not be considered a replacement for sustainability, but a paradigm shift,” explains Dr Inversini. At its heart, regenerative hospitality is about people and place – about creating thriving communities, resilient ecosystems, and experiences that enrich both guests and hosts. By aligning business success with ecological and social regeneration, the hospitality industry can create a multi-dimensional, long-term, positive impact.

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”



Vivian Wei Zhou
EHL IAB Member and
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1
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Le Berceau des Sens

About EHL:

EHL – originally founded as École hôtelière de Lausanne in 1893 – is a hospitality and business education group, recognized as the global leader in hospitality management. The institution brings together a vibrant community of 4,000 students from over 120 nationalities across three campuses in Switzerland and Singapore. At EHL, we educate hearts, hands, and minds – shaping confident, versatile, and resilient leaders for careers in hospitality and other experience-driven industries.

Learn more about EHL
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序言

当今时代，工作模式的变革正以前所未有的速度重塑行业图景。技术进步、代际文化变迁与不断升级的宾客与员工期待，共同推动着酒店及泛服务业的深刻转型。在EHL，我们坚信，成功的企业从不被动适应变化，而是始终走在变革前沿。

EHL学者与行业专家的研究揭示，变革在带来挑战的同时，更孕育着巨大机遇：它激励我们开拓创新，构建以人为本、生态优先的完整体系；推动我们运用创新科技赋能员工与宾客；更重要的是，它驱动我们携手共创更美好的未来职场。

AI智能体作为AI领域的新前沿，正是此类变革机遇的典型代表。这类自主系统能够主动预判需求、独立制定决策并精准执行复杂任务，让员工更专注于酒店及泛服务业的核心价值——人性化服务。

当前，餐饮领域正迎来深刻变革。在可持续理念与科技创新的双重驱动下，从食材采购、烹饪加工到用餐体验的整个价值链正在重构。餐饮服务业凭借其独特地位，有望引领全球迈向更富有意义的饮食体验新阶段。与此同时，消费者对沉浸式旅行体验的追求，也催生出越来越多融合感官刺激与情感共鸣的创新服务形态。

我们与可持续发展的关系也在重构。当“实现净零影响”已成为基本门槛，企业更需要主动回馈社区与生态系统——这种创造“净正面效益”的模式，不仅能实现商业价值，更能彰显社会使命。

“以人为本”的理念，如同一条主线贯穿所有行业变革的进程。面对日益严峻的人力资源挑战，以人为本的领导力比以往任何时候都更重要——它既能提升职场吸引力，更能重塑酒店及泛服务业格局，以迎接未来的所有挑战与机遇。

Markus Venzin
EHL首席执行官

事实与数据

现状

未来10年预期

4.9万亿美元

2024年，全球酒店及泛服务业市场规模从4.67万亿美元增长至4.90万亿美元（资料来源：《2024年酒店及泛服务业全球市场报告》）

3.71亿全球从业者

酒店及泛服务业在全球范围内雇佣约3.71亿员工（资料来源：世界旅行及旅游业理事会）

占据全球1/8的岗位

未来十年，酒店及泛服务业预计将创造超4.6亿个就业岗位，占据全球工作岗位的1/8（资料来源：世界旅行及旅游业理事会）

年均复合增长率预计为5.3%

据预测，未来酒店及泛服务业市场年均复合增长率将达5.3%（资料来源：《2024年酒店及泛服务业全球市场报告》）

市场规模达70,111.3亿美元（2029年预测值）

至2029年，全球酒店及泛服务业市场规模预计将攀升至70,111.3亿美元（资料来源：《2024年酒店及泛服务业全球市场报告》）

2.9万亿美元国际旅游消费总额

未来十年，国际旅游支出预计以3.4%的年均复合增长率增长，达2.9万亿美元（资料来源：世界旅行及旅游业理事会）

占全球经济总量的10.3%

旅行及旅游业为全球经济贡献11.7万亿美元，占全球GDP的10.3%（资料来源：世界旅行及旅游业理事会）

酒店及泛服务 业AI智能体



驱动创新、提升福祉、 打造个性化宾客体验

人工智能（AI）如今已无处不在，成为各类行业会议与专家讲座的核心议题。在酒店及泛服务业，AI工具的重要性日益凸显，逐渐成为一种实用的资源。若能善加利用，它将能有效支持员工、优化运营，并提升员工与宾客的双重福祉。

AI工具的成功应用，不仅依赖于扎实的员工培训及其在运营生态系统中的全面集成，更取决于一个明确的初衷：用AI赋能员工，而非取代他们。秉持这一理念，酒店及泛服务业可以借助AI驱动型系统减轻运营压力，支持员工专注于有意义的宾客互动，打造更具韧性的职场环境，让员工得以成长发展，最终提升宾客体验。

尽管大规模应用尚处发展阶段，AI对酒店及泛服务业的影响已然显现。[Canary Technologies](#)一项关于酒店及泛服务业AI应用的调查显示，在全球327位酒店及泛服务业专业人士中，73%认为AI将对行业产生重大影响。61%的酒店经营者表示AI的影响已初现端倪，或将在未来一年内显现；另有39%的经营者认为其影响将在两年或更长时间后逐步体现。超过80%的受访者预计，AI将深度重塑预订前与宾客的沟通和互动模式，推动实现更个性化、更顺畅的客户联结。

宾客们也日益熟悉AI，并接触到更多旨在提升其旅行体验的AI工具。根据Skift于2025年6月发布的基于逾1000名美国旅行者反馈的《美国旅行追踪调查》，超过半数旅客已开始使用AI工具规划行程。

麦肯锡公司与Skift Research于2025年联合发布的《代理式AI重塑旅游业》报告引用了一项针对86位旅游业高管（他们主要位于美国）的调查，其结果显示：26%的

受访者指出AI应用降低了运营成本，30%称其加速了决策流程，33%认为AI提升了客户个性化体验。此外，36%的受访者观察到工作产出质量提高，59%认为员工的工作效率显著提升。总体而言，多数受访者表示，过去三年间，AI应用推动了年均超6%的营收增长，并实现了同等幅度的成本节约。

酒店及泛服务业AI应用仍待深化

尽管AI在酒店及泛服务业的潜力巨大，但其应用仍相对有限。[HES-SO Valais-Wallis](#)大学2025年对170家欧洲酒店及泛服务业企业的调查显示，当前已部署的AI应用主要集中在三大领域：实时收益管理（42%）、宾客个性化服务（38%）和预测性分析（37%）。分析表明，当前多数酒店倾向于优先采用易于落地、面向宾客的AI工具。



在已引入AI的酒店中，反馈普遍积极。在1至10分的AI效益评分中，受访者给出的平均分为6.6，中位数达7分。近四分之一（23%）的受访者给出了8分的高分，14%甚至给出满分10分。仅有5%表示未看到任何效益。被提及最多的三大优势是：节省时间（76%）、改善沟通（54%）和提升运营效率（51%）。

与此同时，挑战依然突出：部署成本高昂、技术复杂以及技术人才缺乏。此外，数据隐私问题和系统集成难题也同样突出；对拥有复杂传统系统的大型酒店而言，这些问题更为严峻。研究表明，AI唯有融入与企业战略、宾客体验及运营需求高度协同的更广泛的数字化战略时，才能真正释放价值，在提升效率的同时，保留酒店及泛服务业不可或缺的人文温度。

EHL教授兼技术专家Ian Millar指出，“在实践中，这意味着利用AI优化诸如动态定价或需求预测等流程，而非削减岗位。”他强调，AI应作为人类能力的延伸，为员工提供更优的工具、信息与支持。他补充道，“迄今的经验表明：AI确实能提升效率——但若缺乏可靠的系统集成、周密的培训以及对‘人’的需求的关注，其影响力与初衷将大打折扣。”

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”



Ian Millar

EHL高级讲师，创业、创新与酒店
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Jie Yu Kerguignas博士

EHL助理教授，服务营销、变革性营销与技术-用户交互领域专家

AI如何提升员工福祉

除了改善效率，AI还能提升员工福祉。在酒店及泛服务业这一长期面临长工时、高流动率与高压力的领域，员工福祉的提升正日益成为关键议题。EHL教授兼人机交互专家Reza Etemad-Sajadi教授指出，AI可以成为缓解职业倦怠与工作负荷失衡的“缓冲器”。例如，预测性排班系统能预判高压时段并优化人力配置，而AI分析工具则能识别过度加班或缺勤等行为模式，为前瞻性管理提供依据。

此外，AI通过减少重复性任务、实现更均衡的工作分配，也有助于支持员工的心理健康。“当员工从繁杂的行政事务中解放出来，便能更专注于工作中富有创造力、社交互动和服务导向的环节——这些正是提升职业满意度的关键所在，” Etemad-Sajadi博士表示。

他特别强调，AI的部署必须遵循负责任的原则，建立隐私保护、数据安全及道德规范的全方位保障。“若运用得当，AI不仅能提升工作效率，更能积极营造更健康、更可持续的工作环境。”

这一维度对吸引新一代职场人才尤为重要。年轻一代越来越倾向于选择真正关注员工福祉与使命价值的雇主。Etemad-Sajadi博士总结道：“在竞争激烈的人才市场中，那些善用AI打造低压力、高支持的工作环境的企业，将更有可能吸引并留住优秀人才。”

AI工具应赋能员工，而非取代人力

AI工具的另一大优势，在于帮助员工有效应对数字化转型过程的挑战。由EHL助理教授Jie Yu Kerguignas博士主持、瑞士西部高等专业学院（HES-SO）资助的一项最新研究，深入探讨了服务数字化对一线员工工作效率的影响。该研究基于262位酒店及泛服务业从业者的问卷数据及10位酒店行业专家的深度访谈展

开，其研究发现系统故障、操作复杂性以及培训不足，正严重削弱员工效率与服务质量。

网络连接中断、软件版本滞后及高昂的培训成本，不仅加剧员工压力，更可能引发宾客不满。“酒店管理者普遍认同，技术对现代运营至关重要；但倘若技术失灵，整个服务流程就可能迅速陷入瘫痪，” Yu Kerguignas博士解释道。

酒店管理者反复强调：技术不可或缺，但必须可靠且契合实际运营需求。“对IT专家而言直观易用的软件，对酒店及泛服务业的员工来说可能是充满困惑、甚至逻辑混乱的，”瑞士纳沙泰尔美岸酒店行政总监Denis Wang坦言。



若在技术上投入巨资却无法确保稳定性，反而会适得其反——非但未能减负，反而成为新的压力源。对此，Yu Kerguignas博士总结道：

“这正反映出管理层日益清晰的共识：技术固然关键，但唯有在可靠且与业务需求高度协同的前提下，才能真正凸显其价值。”

AI：酒店及泛服务业的战略伙伴

在此背景下，Jie-Yu-Kerguignas博士的后续研究进一步揭示：多数管理者已将AI视为战略伙伴——它不仅帮助员工驾驭技术浪潮，更能有效解决技术本身带来的难题。Chalet RoyAlp温泉酒店总经理Egbert Buursink表示：“当今的AI技术在实现深度个性化的同时，更在于为员工提供支持——其目的绝非替代人力，而是提升他们的工作表现。”事实上，AI并非用于削减岗位，而是用来预测系统故障、减少重复性任务，甚至充当员工的“数字助手”。

该研究显示，业界管理者已形成共识：AI应如静默的基石，在后台巩固运营体系、增强员工信心，同时守护酒店及泛服务业不可或缺的人文温度。“人，才是核心所在。我们必须始终关注技术为‘人’带来的价值，”Corner Collection集团运营副总裁Nicolas Messian表示。

Jie Yu Kerguignas博士最后谈道：“研究清晰表明，酒店领导者并不畏惧AI。恰恰相反，他们正积极尝试可以赋能员工的AI工具。当前最迫切的需求集中在两方面：一是能通过预测故障、简化流程、分析重复性错误，从而提升工作效率的AI解决方案；二是能借助AI教练、聊天机器人和即时指导等功能，支持员工培训与增强员工职业自信的AI工具。”此外，安全性、数据保护及跨司法辖区合规要求仍是酒店集团关注的核心议题，这也意味着AI的广泛应用必须以健全的保障机制为基础，并须承担随之增长的合规成本。

AI智能体的崛起

展望未来，AI智能体正成为最具变革性的创新力量，其影响将遍及酒店及泛服务业、医疗、金融等诸多领域。在2025年2月的一次专访中，微软首席执行官Satya Nadella指出，AI智能体将重塑软件即服务（SaaS）行业的竞争格局。这些智能体作为人与技术之间的核心交互

界面，不仅能实时响应需求、执行任务，还具备跨会话的持续记忆能力，深刻重塑着企业以及消费者个人的数字设备使用模式。

对酒店及泛服务业而言，AI智能体尤为关键，标志着从传统AI到生成式AI后的又一次重大演进。它们不仅能显著提升宾客体验、优化运营流程，还能赋能数据驱动的决策。例如，通过实时分析竞对定价与市场需求，AI智能体可以动态调整客房价格，实现收益与入住率的双重优化。

普华永道旅游、交通与酒店及泛服务业专家Jeanelle Johnson在一次近期的访谈中阐释道：“这些自主决策工具能实时做出判断，无论是定制个性化宾客方案，还是快速解决运营问题，都展现出前所未有的敏捷性。”

“它们能预判需求，提供解决方案，并根据具体情境做灵活调整，有效减少工作干扰，使员工专注于体现酒店及泛服务业精髓的高价值互动。”

代理式AI的实践应用

麦肯锡与Skift Research联合发布的《代理式AI重塑旅游业》报告指出，代理式AI能通过自主处理复杂的实时决策，从多个维度提升酒店运营与资产管理效能：

智能客房分配：根据宾客偏好、会员等级与历史反馈自动分配客房，为前台员工每日节省30分钟至2小时工时。

预测性维护：主动预警设备故障、自主调度维修资源并订购配件，使客房停用时间减少20%-30%。

动态房务管理：基于实时数据动态分配清洁任务，优化工作流的同时缩减10%-30%人力工时。

菜单精益优化：综合分析菜品、定价与库存，助力净利润提升5%-15%。

相较于传统聊天机器人，AI智能体更具主动性，既能实现自然语言交互与多系统集成，还具备执行复杂任务的能力。EHL校友、Apaleo副总裁Florian Montag解释说：“它们能预判需求，提供解决方案，并根据具体情境做灵活调整，有效减少工作干扰，使员工专注于体现酒店及泛服务业精髓的高价值互动。”

对于面临人力短缺的酒店，AI智能体有助于维持服务质量、缓解员工压力并沉淀组织知识——在人员流动率居高不下的部门中，这些价值更是变得愈发宝贵。行业技术专家Montag强调，这并非“机器取代人力”，而是开创一种全新的人机协作模式：由数字助手自主处理繁琐复杂的常规事务，使员工得以专注于他们最擅长的领域——提供真诚的待客服务。

EHL国际咨询委员会（IAB）成员、投资人、Booking.com前首席执行官Gillian Tans，则将AI智能体视为旅游业格局的重塑者。生成式AI可以提前预判旅客需求、消除行程中的

摩擦点，从而打造顺畅、个性化的旅程体验，彻底重塑旅游业的格局。对酒店而言，这意味着从智能需求预测到超个性化宾客体验的运营体系变革，最终实现效率与客户忠诚度的双重跃升。如今，智能体已让目的地探索与行程规划变得轻松高效、充满灵感；而下一阶段的突破，在于AI智能体能够无缝衔接“灵感启发”与“行动执行”——例如，直接为您预订整趟行程。

酒店及泛服务业AI的发展历程印证：科技终将赋能人力，而非取代人力。当AI智能体承担起重复性、数据驱动型及高度复杂的任务时，员工得以更专注于以人为本的服务与有意义的宾客互动。只要配合审慎的培训体系、可靠的系统集成及健全的伦理保障，AI就能成为提升员工福祉、优化运营效率、增强宾客满意度的强大工具——证明“以人为本”与技术创新不仅能够共存，更能相互成就，共同塑造行业更光明的未来。

“
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点——彻底重塑旅游业
的格局。

”



Florian Montag
EHL校友，酒店及泛服务业技术公司
Apaleo副总裁



Gillian Tans
EHL国际咨询委员会（IAB）成
员、投资人、Booking.com前首
席执行官

未来餐饮图景

未来餐饮图景



从餐饮服务的可持续发展到食品生产中的科技创新

食物早已不只是果腹之需，更成为了我们生活方式、价值取向乃至社会走向的一面镜子。它联结人群、滋养身心、凝聚社群、传承文化，并塑造着我们的身份认同。在美食、营养与健康领域，新趋势层出不穷，推动整个食品行业持续演进、重塑自我。从对健康的关注到可持续发展的实践，从技术创新到文化认同，食物的生产、制作与消费方式正经历深刻变革。

EHL《2025年食品与健康福祉报告》将食物视为一种多维度的福祉杠杆——其意义远不止于提供营养，更深刻关联着身心健康、生活意义、文化传承以及地球生态的完整性。报告揭示了若干关键发展趋势：消费者理性意识的崛起、便捷性与个性化需求的深度融合，以及整个食品生态系统中“共同责任”理念的逐步形成。

研究同时表明，酒店及泛服务业在推动这一转型中具备独特优势——其餐饮服务每日触达大量宾客，是引领变革的关键力量。酒店与餐厅有能力引导供应链改革，设计更具健康意识的菜单，推广促进人际联结的餐饮模式，并在运营中践行透明与创新。通过这些举措，行业不仅能满足消费者对美味的 basic 需求，更能回应他们对食物的深层期待：追求富有意义、具备再生价值，并兼顾个人健康与地球福祉的饮食未来。

餐饮服务业的可持续发展

在这一变革浪潮中，餐饮服务业正扮演着尤为关键的角色，其核心挑战在

于——既要回应人们对可持续发展日益高涨的期待，又需兼顾盈利能力和运营灵活性。EHL近期开展的瑞士餐饮服务业可持续转型：重塑未来餐饮服务新方式》（STRest）研究，深入探讨了瑞士餐饮服务企业如何应对这一挑战：不再满足于渐进式改进，而是迈向根本性的系统重构。

该项目聚焦可持续转型与可持续商业模式创新，对超过500家餐厅、酒店、餐饮服务商及咖啡馆的实践及其所面临的障碍与驱动因素展开了全面调研，涵盖采购、废弃物处理、能源管理和数字化等领域的实践。完整的研究成果将通过EHL全球传播渠道向行业、政策制定者及公众发布。

研究指出，餐饮服务企业在塑造消费习惯、减少食物浪费以及引导采购行为方面占据核心地位，因而具备推动整个食品价值链实现系统性变革的巨大潜力。通过将可持续转型（ST）理论与可持续商业模式创新（SBMI）相结合，该研究为行业探索更具韧性、更负责任的实践路径提供了全新思路。



（资料来源：EHL酒店管理商学院、瑞士西部高等专业学院（HES-SO））

研究强调，小型餐饮服务企业能够采纳多样化的可持续创新方案——既包括减少废弃物和推行循环实践（如环保堆肥、闭环供应链），也涵盖通过数字化手段提升能源与资源使用效率的解决方案。该研究的作者EHL教授Carlos Martin-Rios博士指出：“我们的研究表明，可持续创新在降低环境影响的同时，更能增强企业竞争力——开辟新的收入来源，提升运营效率，并吸引注重可持续发展的消费者。”他同时补充道：“要将试点方案转化为日常实践，企业需要三大支撑：面向厨房改造的小额融资、鼓励减废节能的采购政策，以及建立回收与数据共享的供应商合作协议。”

对行业而言，关键结论已然明晰：可持续发展正日益成为决定企业成败的关键因素。尽管对小型经营者而言，全面践行可持续实践仍然面临诸多挑战，但其参与对实现气候目标与食品系统转型至关重要。Martin-Rios博士强调：

“研究揭示了，必须在短期运营需求与长期环境目标之间取得平衡——可持续发展不仅是道德责任，更是未来餐饮服务业竞争力与韧性的核心驱动力。”他特别指出，餐饮行业可持续发展必须突破精英化概念的局限。“可持续必须变得普及且可负担，不能仅限于高端市场。当主流运营商大规模地将可持续融入核心运营而非作为附加选项时，才能真正推动进步。当一家连锁企业做出改进，其影响力会通过数百万份餐食成倍放大。与此同时，高端餐饮则扮

演着‘创新实验室’的角色，引领理念革新、塑造行业规范。我们既需要规模带来的广泛影响，也离不开先锋点燃的变革火花。”

重塑人与食物的联结纽带

在可持续考量因素影响下，食品的生产方式也正经历着深刻的转型。过去四十年间，工业化国家的消费者与食物源头渐行渐远。当今大多数食品都经由工业化加工，生产与消费之间隔着层层中间环节。虽然工业化带来了预期寿命提升与三餐稳定供应等益处，但也让人与食物之间产生了物理与心理的双重隔阂。正因如此，越来越多人渴望重新建立与食物生产过程的联结。这一需求背后，折射出当代社会对真实性、透明度与可持续实践的深切向往。

围绕食品生产的讨论，也反映出消费者对深加工食品日益明显的排斥。全球健康研究所的一份报告显示，消费者正逐渐远离过度加工的工业食品，转而追求更健康、更天然、更洁净的可持续饮食选择。虽然植物基食品的兴起仍具有重要意义，但市场对那些充斥添加剂、糖分或人工香精的深加工替代品的兴趣正在明显减弱。与之形成显著对比的是，功能性食品、发酵工艺以及保留营养与风味的烹饪方式，正受到越来越多的关注。



Carlos Martin-Rios博士
EHL教授，可持续发展、创新与管理领域专家



Inès Blai博士
EHL教授、EHL营养研究与开发研究院联合主任



Antonin Soussan
EHL讲师、EHL营养研究与开发研究院项目经理

“
我们的实践充分证明，跨学科研究能够打造出更健康、更天然，同时满足现代市场需求的优质产品。
”

在此背景下，EHL营养研究与开发研究院将“创造美味、营养且可持续的食品与饮品”作为核心使命。EHL教授兼EHL营养研究与开发研究院联合主任Inès Blal博士表示，“我们意识到，当前食品体系面临诸多挑战。凭借EHL在美食学与商业管理领域的独特专长，我们正助力开发美味、营养且可持续的产品。”

该研究院携手行业伙伴、科学家、专家与厨师，致力于减少添加剂的使用、用天然食材代替人工成分，并运用先进的烹饪与保鲜技术——如精准温控烹饪、无化学防腐剂的保质期延长工艺等。Inès Blal博士总结道，“我们的实践充分证明，跨学科研究能够打造出更健康、更天然，同时满足现代市场需求的优质产品。”

科技如何重塑食品生产

跨学科研究的另一成功典范是Robo-Cake（机器人蛋糕）项目。EHL的甜品师与食品科学家联合瑞士洛桑联邦理工学院（EPFL）及意大利技术研究院的科研团队，共同开发出一款可食用的机器人蛋糕。EHL讲师兼EHL营养研究与开发研究院项目经理Antonin Soussan解释道：“虽然这并非面向大众市场的产品，但未来，这类可食用机器人有望以创新方式为吞咽困难人群递送药物，或为危机地区输送食品。”



RoboCake虽为细分领域，却是科技如何深刻影响着食品生产的缩影。另一项关键突破是区块链技术——其在食品质量控制与溯源领域展现出独特价值。EHL教授Marc Stierand博士说道：“区块链为食品供应链赋予更强的透明度与可追溯性，让消费者可直溯原料源头。”通过提供不可篡改的交易记录，区块链让消费者与企业能实时验证食品的原产地、流通轨迹与品质。Stierand博士曾担任瑞士食品与营养谷理事会成员多年，他补充道：“这不仅保障了食品安全，更通过验证食物的真实性与可持续性建立起了消费者的信任。”

奥塔哥大学的一项研究——《区块链驱动的食品供应链：系统性评估未开发的机遇》，系统梳理了区块链技术在食品供应链中的多元应用，并指出未来的创新方向——包括食品捐赠与再分配、供应链金融、动物福祉及食物垃圾管理等。此外，Settle Mint发布的行业报告《区块链转型现状：供应链篇》指出，86%的供应链管理者认为，运用区块链能为企业带来竞争优势。

“我不相信技术应该替代‘人’。食物的本质在于人——在于人的技艺、直觉与热忱。”

与此同时，真空低温烹饪等创新技术正在颠覆传统烹饪模式。Stierand博士指出：“真空低温烹饪技术通过真空密封与精准温控，既能保留食物营养又能提升风味。”这种烹饪技术能制作出口感更佳、质地更优的健康餐食，精准呼应消费者对“兼具美味与营养的食品”的追求。2025年，EHL应用艺术学院院长Patrick Ogheard参与合著的《精准温控烹饪》（La Cuisson à Juste Température）（Hachette Pratique出版社）正式出版，该书系统阐述了这一烹饪技术的科学与风味传承体系。

EHL国际咨询委员会（IAB）成员、莫西曼私人餐饮俱乐部及Global Events常务董事Philipp Mosimann同样看好科技与美食结合的潜力：

“我认为，科技在塑造未来餐饮图景中正扮演着愈发关键的角色。从助力减废节水、提升产量的智慧农业，到通过AI菜单规划帮助厨师优化食材、大幅减少浪费的智能厨房——科技在食品供应链全程的应用令人惊叹。”但Mosimann同时强调，科技不应取代人的核心地位：“技术不应该替代‘人’。食物的本质在于人——在于人的技艺、直觉与热忱。真正的机遇在于用科技赋能这份匠心，让厨师与生产者更专注于风味、体验与故事叙述，而科技则默默处理后勤与可持续性数据等后台工作。”

这些发现表明，在可持续发展诉求、消费者对本真性的追求及新技术崛起的共同驱动下，食品体系正历经巨大变革。对酒店及泛服务业而言，这是挑战，更是机遇。

积极拥抱这些转变，酒店及泛服务业将不仅能参与饮食内容的变革，更能推动食材采购、烹饪制作与体验方式的全面进化。这是一段需要所有利益相关者——从农民、厨师到消费者——共同奔赴的旅程，每个人都将为塑造更可持续、更有意义的未来餐饮图景贡献关键力量。



Marc Stierand博士

EHL教授，“烹饪创造力”领域奠基人、商业创造力与审美领导力领域专家



Philipp Mosimann

EHL国际咨询委员会（IAB）成员、莫西曼私人餐饮俱乐部及Global Events常务董事

领导力新纪元

领导力新纪元



以人为本的领导力塑造未来职场

尤其是在AI快速发展的时代背景下，“以人为本”的理念与情商正变得愈发重要。随着越来越多的员工在工作中追求成就感与使命价值，以人为本的价值观正日益成为打造有吸引力、健康、可持续且充满幸福感的工作环境的关键所在。

当“以人为本”的理念深度融入酒店及泛服务业的核心，其影响已超越宾客体验的维度，更深刻重构了组织内部的员工关系，进而打造出更现代化、更具吸引力的工作环境，从而为企业吸引和留住人才提供持久动力。在酒店及泛服务业面临严峻人力短缺的当下，这种领导力模式的转型尤为迫切。尤其值得注意的是，行业正迎来强劲增长：未来几年，酒店与旅游业将迎来显著增长，全球旅客数量预计将持续攀升。根据世界旅行及旅游业理事会（WTTC）的数据，旅行及旅游业所产生的GDP目前已占全球GDP的10.3%。未来几年，全球酒店及泛服务业市场规模预计将达70,111.3亿美元，年均复合增长率（CAGR）约为5.3%。尽管目前全球酒店及泛服务业从业人员约为3.71亿人，但未来十年内，行业对劳动力的需求预计将超过4.6亿。

然而，众多调查显示，行业正面临人才招聘的困境。美国酒店与住宿协会（AHLA）的一项调查表明，65%的酒店存在人手不足的情况。尽管许多酒店已通过提高薪资、提供弹性工时等激励措施来提升人才招聘的吸引力，但行业整体就业人数仍比疫情前低近10%。在该调查中，47%的酒店经营者将提高薪资视为吸引和留住人才的首要策略，20%选择提供弹性工时，13%提供酒店住宿或消费折扣，另有9%则通过参加招聘会和投放招聘广告来吸引求职者。

人手不足导致常规运营难以维持，进而引发服务质量下降、服务项目缩减与收入减少。根据瑞士酒店业协会2022年的一项调查，约60%的企业因人手短缺不得不调整服务内容，而那些面临招聘困难的企业平均收入损失达4%。

因此，面对市场的快速扩张，酒店及泛服务业必须为未来储备充足的专业人才。这不仅要求行业革新工作模式，例如，EHL《2025年酒店及泛服务业展望》中《新型工作模式：通过现代化发展与人才管理实现职业福祉的蓝图》所阐述的模式；更亟需在企业内部培育以人为本的领导力，从而构建更具吸引力的工作环境。这一根本性转变将推动职场文化的全面重塑，使企业运营的核心从“以宾客为中心”的传统模式，真正转向“宾客需求与员工福祉并重”的全新模式。

以人为本的领导者的核心特质

情商（一种所谓的“软技能”）是构建以人为本的领导力的基石。研究与咨询公司高德纳的研究指出，以人为本的领导者具备三项关键特质：**真诚**：能够展现真实自我，并以清晰的使命感行事；**共情**：真正关心员工的需求与福祉；**灵活**：积极调整工作条件，更好地支持员工的个性化需求。

EHL教授Sébastien Fernandez指出，一位真诚的领导者首先需要深刻认识自我。他表示，“真诚始于自我认知，”同时强调保持坦诚与透明同样关键：“在践行这种领导风格时，勇于坦承自己的失误、承认自身弱点与表达疑虑至关重要。”

此外，波士顿咨询公司2022年的一项调研进一步揭示了以人为本的领导者的其他特质，包括：体贴周到、善于倾听、注重团队成长、持续自我反思与高度透明。

“
在践行这种领导风格时，勇于坦承自己的失误、承认自身弱点与表达疑虑至关重要。

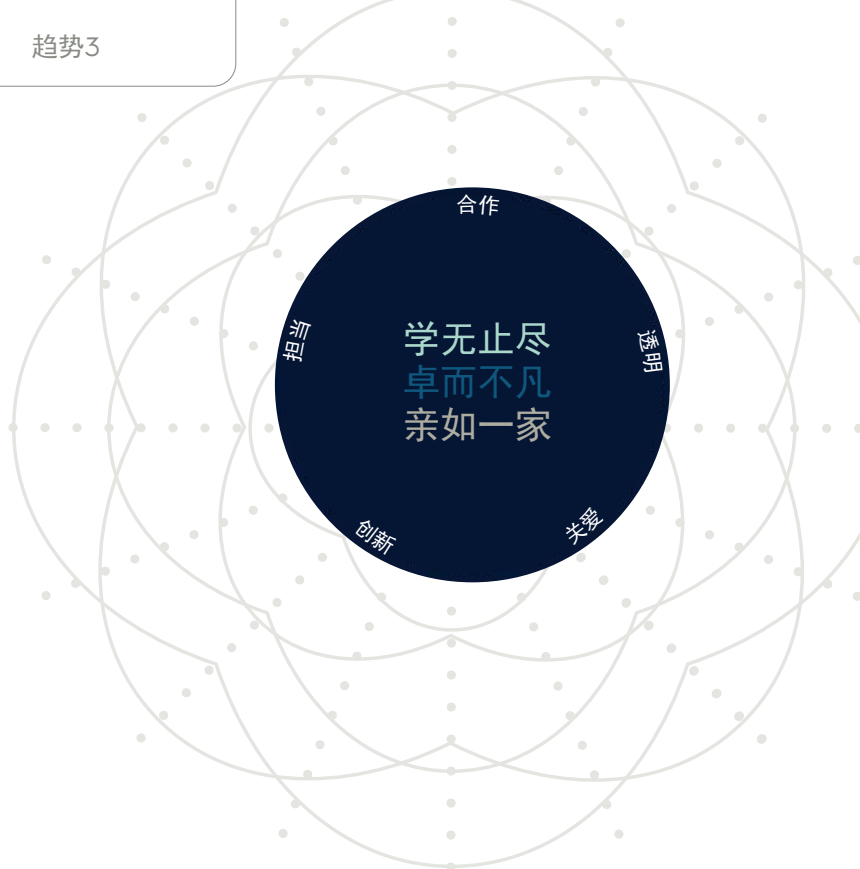
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员工幸福即企业健康之基石

当今职场中，员工的主要诉求已发生深刻演变。在疫情催化及年轻世代价值观重塑的双重影响下，员工不再仅仅追求稳定，而是更渴望使命价值、福祉保障与有道德的领导。正因如此，以人为本的领导力已成为企业吸引和保留人才的关键差异化优势。高德纳的研究显示，拥有以人为本的领导者的团队，员工敬业度提升了37%，而高敬业度团队的整体绩效也相较高出27%。

华威大学的另一项研究进一步揭示，幸福感较高的员工工作效率高出12%，有力印证了员工福祉与工作绩效之间的直接关联。数据显示，83%的员工将福祉视为与薪酬同等重要；更有77%的员工表示，若企业忽视员工福祉，他们会考虑离职。

以人为本的领导力通过营造心理安全感，鼓励开放对话与勇于创新的文化，有效激发创造力与创新活力。这种领导风格最终将培育出更健康、更真实的工作场域——以信任、共情和透明沟通为基石，让员工个人追求与企业使命同频共振。



EHL于2023年正式推出全新领导力模型。由EHL社群共同设计的“Tempo”倡议，根植于代表EHL精神的三大核心价值——学无止境、卓而不凡与亲如一家，并凝练为五大领导与管理原则：透明、创新、合作、关爱、担当。正如EHL首席执行官Markus Venzin所言：“塑造EHL文化，意味着运用Tempo领导与管理原则影响我们的工作环境与文化氛围，从而确保我们能为整个EHL社群提供富有意义的体验。”



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EHL组织行为学副教授



Markus Venzin教授
EHL首席执行官

Z世代员工尤为看重以人为本的领导

尽管以人为本的理念对任何年龄段的员工都至关重要，但Z世代员工对此尤为重视。德勤2025年发布的《Z世代与千禧一代调研》显示，年轻一代正在重新定义成功——他们更重视学习成长、员工福祉与使命价值，而非传统的职业晋升。仅有6%的受访者将成为领导角色视为首要职业目标，而高达70%的Z世代和59%的千禧一代会在工作之余定期学习新技能。相比纯粹的技术专长，他们更看重共情、沟通等软技能。对年轻一代而言，以人为本的领导至关重要：86%的受访者认为，富有导师精神、具备同理心且以使命价值为导向的管理方式，是获得良好工作体验的关键。

EHL教授Stefano Borzillo博士近期与瑞士西部高等专业学院（HES-SO）合作开展了一项研究：《确保酒店业Z世代人才储备：酒店经营者与未来毕业生的观点对比》。该研究深入调研了酒店及泛服务管理专业的学生和酒店总经理对酒店及泛服务业吸引Z世代人才举措的看法，发现以人为本的领导是Z世代关注的核心议题。“受访的Z世代酒店及泛服务管理专业的学生强调，他们希望看到更扁平化的组织架构、跨部门协作以及项目制工作模式，而酒店总经理们也意识到脱离僵化架构的重要性，” Borzillo

博士还补充道，“此外，学生们还表达了对‘有毒的’职场文化、职场骚扰以及企业‘漂绿’现象的担忧，呼吁推行真正真诚的领导方式，并在多元化、包容性及企业社会责任（CSR）方面展现切实承诺。”

现有研究表明，企业在招聘Z世代时，应设计强调自主性与成就感的岗位，同时给予他们安全感。当酒店的CSR倡议与Z世代的价值观相契合时，更能激发他们的归属感与信任感——这对吸引和留住人才至关重要。

此外，酒店及泛服务管理专业的学生对实习经历的满意度直接影响其从业意愿。影响实习体验的关键因素包括：与同事及主管的关系、所获技能的实用性、实习内容与课程的相关性、导师提供的指导与反馈质量，以及实习企业的总体架构。

EHL与瑞士西部高等专业学院（ES-SO）的研究还指出，透明度与公平性是留住Z世代人才的关键。Borzillo博士表示，“他们期望清晰的职业发展路径、透明的晋升标准和公正的激励机制，并将这些视为建立信任的基础。”研究同时发现，Z世代高度重视雇主是否真正关心员工福祉，例如是否提供弹性工时、心理健康支持等举措。



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Frank Marrenbach
EHL国际咨询委员会（IAB）成员、Althoff酒店集团首席执行官

要进一步打破部门壁垒，促进知识共享与最佳实践的协作共享。”他还强调，Z世代也格外看重反馈文化以及跨层级的互动。“回顾实习经历时，受访学生最遗憾的就是与管理层互动不足。定期的互动与反馈会对员工产生积极影响，尤其在职业生涯的起步阶段。因此，培养真实而有温度的人际互动，是增加酒店业对Z世代吸引力的关键所在。

以人为本： 跨越年龄与层级的领导力真谛

构建以人为本的领导力文化，不仅有助于吸引新生代和未来人才，更能为各个世代的员工与管理者带来深远而积极的影响。EHL教授Bertrand Audrin博士指出，商界和行业不应过度强调不同世代之间的需求差异。“我们经常习惯用代际标签来简化管理，遗憾的是，Z世代在商界中已被贴上了太多刻板标签。事实上，年轻一代之所以备受关注，是因为他们敢于挑战现状，并致力于推动社会进步——希望建立一个更重视使命价值与员工福祉的未来职场文化。”

Audrin博士同时强调，领导力的本质不由头衔定义，而取决于团队的感知与认可，“因为最终评判领导者成功与否的，正是团队本身。”

真正的领导力，在于营造一种让团队成员敢于表达想法、勇于挑战既有观点的职场环境。要打造这样的团队，离不开有意识的经营：挑选合适人才、营造安全感，并持续维护团队内部的良性互动。“团队是一个生态系统，需要以人为本的领导者持之以恒地滋养。”

正因如此，以人为本的领导力与所有员工息息相关，无论年龄层与岗位，这更是每一位未来领导者必须掌握的关键能力。EHL国际咨询

委员会（IAB）成员、Althoff酒店集团首席执行官Frank Marrenbach认为，领导力是塑造酒店及泛服务业未来的关键议题之一。“领导力是优秀企业与卓越企业的分水岭，”他还强调以人为本的领导力应成为一项需及早培养的核心竞争力。“未来的酒店及泛服务业领导者，必须具备理解人心的能力，有意愿深入探索人性的复杂性，并保有与之相匹配的好奇心。当然，扎实的软技能也必不可少——既能主动倾听，又能形成独立见解，同时不固执己见。我认为，这是一项至关重要的能力。”

Marrenbach还特别强调，韧性与共情能力是为本的领导者不可或缺的核心能力。“当今世界高度复杂，领导者必须具备韧性——无论面对何种挑战，都能保持坚定的心态和充沛的能量。更重要的是，他们应有能力在困境中主动转化局势，将困境转化为积极且富有成效的行动，同时始终以同理心关怀他人。”

归根结底，以人为本不仅是一种管理趋势，更是组织在对待员工、文化与绩效方面必经的进化之路。面对人才短缺、员工价值观演变以及技术加速迭代等多重挑战，酒店及泛服务业亟需打造促进员工福祉、使命价值与协作精神的职场环境，同时培养具备同理心、自省能力与真诚品格的领导者。以这些价值观为基石，以人为本的领导力将有能力塑造出一个对未来多代人都富有吸引力的职场环境，不仅提升员工的满意度，也能惠及宾客与社群。

“未来的酒店及泛服务业领导者，必须具备理解人心的能力，有意愿深入探索人性的复杂性，并保有与之相匹配的好奇心。”

酒店及泛服务业 的沉浸式体验



酒店及泛服务业引领沉浸式体验经济

数十年来，酒店及泛服务业始终走在体验经济的前沿。继农业革命、工业革命及服务业发展之后，全球经济迎来了第四大增长引擎——体验经济。如今，这一经济形态正加速演进：消费者不再满足于难忘的体验，而是追求真正沉浸式的深度参与。在这一转型中，酒店及泛服务业中的企业凭借其天然优势，正成为引领变革的核心力量。

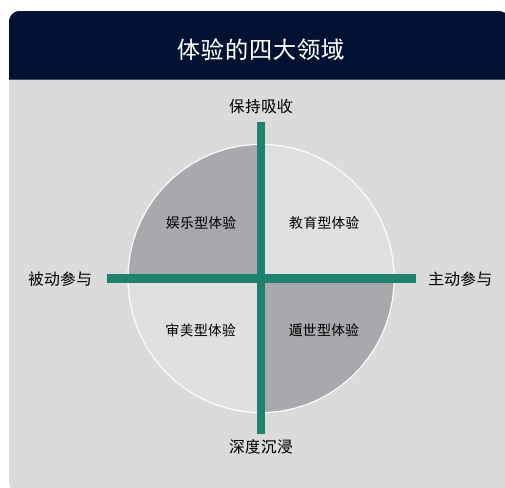
传统上，经济学家常将“体验”归类为服务的一种，但体验实则作为一种独立的经济价值形态。如今，这一点愈发清晰：在消费者日益渴望有意义、有共鸣的互动，以及企业愈加专注于设计与推广体验的双重驱动下，体验本身已成为一种独立的产品。

对酒店及泛服务业而言，这蕴含着巨大的增长潜力。包含瑞士宝盛关于生活方式的调查在内的一系列研究显示，当代消费者更愿意为体验而非实物产品买单。贝恩公司携手意大利奢侈品行业协会阿尔塔伽玛的研究报告也指出，2024年，体验类消费增幅最为显著——消费者将旅行、社交活动和健康体验置于传统物质消费之上。

体验经济的四种类型

正如《哈佛商业评论》所言，体验并非抽象概念，而是像服务、商品一样的具象经济产物。在当今服务驱动型经济中，众多企业通过为传统产品注入体验元素来增强吸引力。然而，要真正释放体验的价值，企业需更进一步——主动设计引人入胜、令人沉浸、并让消费者愿意为之付费的独特体验。

根据学者Pine和Gilmore提出的著名的“体验经济”理论框架，所有体验可按两大维度划分为四大领域。第一维度是顾客参与程度，其范围从作为观察者的**被动参与**（如观看音乐会或戏剧），到直接融入体验的**主动参与**（如滑雪或在戏剧中登台表演）。第二维度是个体与环境的联结深度，从**吸收型体验**（如观看电影时远距离接收信息）延伸至**沉浸型体验**（如虚拟现实仿真中的全身心融入）。



资料来源：《哈佛商业评论》

据此，体验可根据这两个维度划分为四大领域，每一领域都对应着不同的维度组合：**娱乐型体验**（被动参与，保持吸收）；**教育型体验**（主动参与，保持吸收）；**遁世型体验**（主动参与，深度沉浸）；**审美型体验**（被动参与，深度沉浸）。最具吸引力的体验往往融合四大领域的元素，在认知、情感与感官层面全方位触动宾客，形成深度共鸣的“理想交汇点”。

EHL助理教授Valentina Clergue博士强调，对酒店及泛服务业而言，体验经济并非新概念。数十年来，行业已在诸多方面深刻践行了这一理念。然而，真正的变革在于体验方式正从被动接受转向主动共创。“过去，宾客满足于像观看演唱会这样的被动享受，如今更渴望参与烹饪课程、沉浸式晚宴等主动参与和共创的体验。我们正迈向一种更具整体性的体验营销与消费模式：沉浸不仅让人暂时逃离日常，更能建立持久的情感联结。”

她进一步指出：“酒店及泛服务业始终致力于提升宾客体验。随着服务与产品日益丰富，宾客的需求也在不断升级——他们追求能全身心投入、富有情感共鸣的深层次体验。”

“
我们正迈向一种更具整体性的体验营销与消费模式：沉浸不仅让人暂时逃离日常，更能建立持久的情感联结。
”

Clergue博士强调，酒店及泛服务业的独特竞争力，恰恰在于其无可替代的“人文内核”。

“在酒店及泛服务业中，精心设计的空间仅是舞台，真实动人的人际联结才是主角。在美术馆，你或许不需要他人接待或服务；但在酒店，人与人的联结本身就是体验的核心。”

人际联结： 酒店及泛服务业的独特魅力之源

以宾客及其需求与渴望为体验核心，酒店及泛服务业具备得天独厚的优势，能够充分挖掘新兴沉浸式体验经济中的巨大潜力。EHL教授Meng-Mei Maggie Chen博士指出：“酒店及泛服务业的基因根植于待客之道、愉悦体验，以及最本质的基于人际互动的交流。这也可归结为‘好客的氛围’这一概念——即由人与空间共同创造出的积极能量。”

正是这种以人为本、以宾客为中心的基因，吸引着奢侈品、医疗健康等行业的企业纷纷与酒店及泛服务业企业展开合作，以提升自身客户体验。例如，特斯拉在洛杉矶开设融合汽车影院的餐厅，拉尔夫·劳伦在吉隆坡推出主题咖啡馆，宝格丽则在全球多地开设奢华酒店。



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Meng-Mei Maggie Chen博士
EHL市场营销副教授



Matthias Fuchs博士
EHL市场营销学助理教授兼客户体验管理研究所主任

在打造沉浸式体验时，创意的边界无限广阔。可运用的工具与元素多种多样，其中包括：游戏化设置：将游戏设计元素与原则应用于非游戏场景，有效提升宾客参与度；另一种有效工具是故事叙述，例如将产品巧妙融入一个富有情节和沉浸感的体验框架中。

法国奢侈品牌爱马仕在纽约打造的限时快闪店，便是沉浸式体验的典范。它将活动空间精心布置成了“犯罪现场”，为宾客提供了一场引人入胜的悬疑解谜体验。陈博士评价道：“该奢侈品牌通过游戏化设置与故事叙述，为客户创造了独特、难忘且深度沉浸的体验。”

感官体验与科技赋能

品牌可充分运用能调动五大感官（触觉、视觉、听觉、嗅觉与味觉）的元素，例如光线、香氛、材质与声效，来深化情感联结。这些体验植根于感官营销理念，其目的不再是提供功能性服务，而是通过调动感官创造令人难忘、引发情感共鸣的深度体验。

“调动感官是塑造难忘体验的关键。体验所激发的感官越多，其影响就越深刻持久。因为感官线索能超越功能本身，通过激活多重感知来唤起情感，才能营造真正的沉浸感，”陈博士强调。

现实中的例子比比皆是：旅客能在机场免税店一眼认出庞贝蓝钻金酒，这得益于其标志性的蓝色瓶身；即便非网飞用户，也能凭标志性的片头音辨识平台；同样，象牙香皂或强生婴儿洗发水的熟悉气息，也能瞬间将人们带回童年，唤起深沉怀旧之情。

科技正通过创造全新的互动与沉浸形式，加速酒店及泛服务业中体验经济的演进。诸如 Le Petit Chef 与哥本哈根的 Alchemist 等沉浸式餐厅，通过投影映射、故事叙事与感官设计，将用餐升华为一场多重感官之旅。

“
该奢侈品牌通过游戏化设置与故事叙述，为客户创造了独特、难忘且深度沉浸的体验

”

虚拟现实（VR）与增强现实（AR）技术也在重塑酒店及泛服务业的体验。VR使宾客能远程探索酒店与目的地，优化预订流程；AR则通过数字菜单、本地信息等交互功能丰富住店体验。餐厅广泛采用互动屏幕点餐与互动，酒店则提供个性化客房娱乐。越来越多品牌融合这些工具，打造以故事驱动的沉浸体验，让每一次到访不仅难忘，更能激发深层的情感共鸣。

陈博士特别强调，打造沉浸式体验未必需要巨额投入。她表示，“任何规模的企业都拥有独特的细分机遇，通过将体验融入服务，帮助人们重新连接真实生活并产生人际互动。例如，荷兰一家洗衣店已成功转型为共享美食、结识新友，甚至举办派对的多元空间。”

现场活动与品牌定制奢享活动

现场活动正日益成为影响旅行决策的关键因素，旅客们追求的已远不止于观光。数据显示，人们参与活动往往不仅为活动本身，更是为了丰富旅途记忆。拉斯维加斯球型场馆与科罗拉多红石公园露天剧场等地标性场馆的走红，正是这一趋势的生动体现。宾客或许会为在一处独特场地体验演唱会的悸动，而去聆听一个从未听闻的乐队。

除现场活动外，EHL教授Matthias Fuchs博士还指出，品牌定制奢享生活体验正悄然兴起。近年来，活动行业呈现出向“微活动”转型的趋势——这些小型聚会旨在促成参与者间更深度的联结与互动。

“尤其明显的是，越来越多伴侣选择规模更小、但融入更多个性化细节以彰显独特品味的婚礼，” Fuchs博士补充说道。

以爱彼的AP House为例，这些私密奢享空间完美诠释了品牌的精致美学与雅致格调。“这些坐落于世界名城的场所，让贵宾得以在优雅环境中庆生，享受量身定制且难忘的体验。” Fuchs博士认为，随着客户需求增长，这一模式还将持续拓展。

“尽管尚未成为现实，但不难想象，未来

由迪奥等奢侈品牌定制的专属婚礼——从量身打造的婚纱设计，到融入品牌美学的场景布置，全方位将品牌的奢华美学、精致格调与个性化理念注入宾客人生的重要时刻。这不仅能够营造高度沉浸且难忘的体验，也将进一步深化他们对品牌的忠诚度。”

麦肯锡的一项研究证实，客户忠诚度不再仅由产品驱动，更源于是否拥有值得付费的体验。酒店及泛服务业品牌与旅行服务商可借此契机，独立或跨界联合奢侈品、健康医疗等行业，精心策划独特而难忘的体验内容，在竞争中脱颖而出。在选择日益丰富的背景下，餐厅、酒店等旅行触点更应顺势而为，打造引发旅客共鸣、令旅程难忘的珍贵时刻。

EHL国际咨询委员会（IAB）成员，25hours Hotels集团和Bikini Island & Mountain Hotels集团创始人Christoph Hoffmann对此深有体会，“在我看来，沉浸式体验之所以变得如此重要且广受欢迎，正是因为过去几年来，全球宾客与旅客的期待已变得愈发精细与成熟。”

Hoffmann在全球多个城市打造了极具个性的精品酒店。每一家25hours酒店都独一无二，其趣味设计从所在地的艺术、文化、美食与故事中汲取灵感。“我们通过故事叙述与空间设计，致力于提供高水准的个性化体验。我们构建酒店风格时，并不一味追求美学设计，而是致力于为宾客创造一种独特的体验，同时始终围绕一个核心问题：入住25hours酒店能为宾客带来怎样的独特价值？

随着酒店及泛服务业与其他行业的边界持续交融，沉浸式体验经济正带来无限的创新机遇与增长空间。以创意、科技与个性化为翼，酒店及泛服务业将继续引领风潮，将沉浸式体验经济推向全新发展篇章。



Christoph Hoffmann
EHL国际咨询委员会（IAB）
成员，25hours Hotels集团
和Bikini Island & Mountain
Hotels集团创始人

再生型待客之道

再生型待客之道



深度融合人文、地域与生态

可持续发展长久以来一直是酒店及泛服务业的重要议题。为应对环境倡议、温室气体减排法规以及日益稀缺的水资源等问题，企业、宾客与消费者都在重新思考自身角色。消费者对生态旅游、可持续实践与绿色出行的兴趣日益浓厚，相关选择也更为普及和亲民。葡萄牙ISG商业与经济学院的一项研究显示，被视为更具可持续性的酒店往往能获得更高的客户忠诚度；而美国东北农业和资源经济学协会的一项研究发现，消费者甚至愿意为餐厅的碳减排计划支付（约6%的）额外费用。

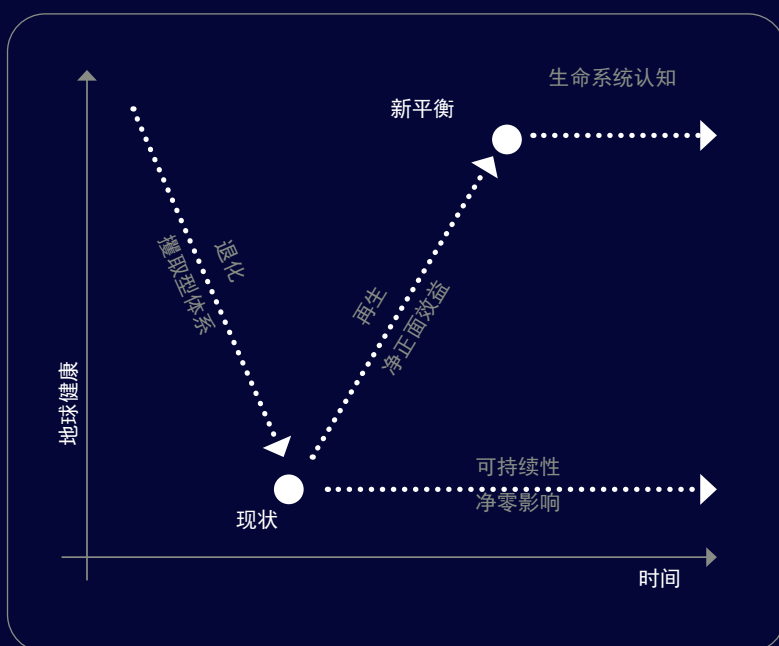
然而，尽管“实现净零影响”多年来一直是行业准则，越来越多的研究与实践表明，“减少损害”已远远不够。事实上，研究显示，宾客的期望早已超越传统可持续的范畴。

由此，“**再生型待客之道**”理念应运而生——这一理念将思维模式从“**净零影响**”转变为“**净正面效益**”，旨在积极修复生态系统、增强社群韧性，并为**人与环境**创造净正向价值。可持续性以“降低负面影响”衡量成效——例如减碳、节水、降耗；而再生则聚焦于“回馈”。不仅如此，再生型待客之道的核心在于，运用**生命系统互联**的逻辑：即我们周围的一切无论是社会、关系、经济或生态系统，皆可视为一个整体生命系统的一部分；而这些系统深度交织，任一系统（如社会系统）的改变都将引发另一系统（如生态系统）的连锁反应。例如，酒店并非孤立存在，而是与周边环境、自然景观、本地食材供应链、文化传统以及宾客、员工和社群的福祉紧密相连。

正如《**再生型待客之道的兴起**》合著者EHL教授Alessandro Inversini博士所阐释的：“再生经济学以互联性为起点。酒店不是孤立的商业实体，而是社群与生态网络的一部分。再生，就是要让这种联结变得可见、可感，并为所有相关方创造积极价值。”

近期另一项研究《**再生型待客之道评估**》，提出了七大支柱——再生思维、互联性、地域融合、本地化影响、整体福祉、共创共塑与动态演化，作为推动再生型待客之道的潜在驱动力。

对部分酒店而言，再生实践可体现为生态修复项目：开展红树林复育、支持生物多样性、推行土地再野化。对其他酒店，再生实践则可能意味着社会系统的再生：打造本地艺术家展演空间、为本地社群提供培训，或设立联结居民的创新中心。无论何种形式，其目标都不止于抵消损害，而是创造切实的新价值。



（资料来源：EHL）

聚焦人文智慧与地域智慧

传统可持续实践往往聚焦于环境议题，却容易忽视社会公平、经济结构及文化动态等更广泛的系统性挑战。此类可持续声明也常陷入“漂绿”争议。当今气候变化、系统性不公及地缘政治动荡等全球性危机的规模之广，已非局部性、渐进式解决方案所能应对；而是亟需协同性、系统性和结构性的彻底变革。

为回应这一需求，EHL酒店管理商学院与HES-SO Valais-Wallis大学联合开发了《再生型待客之道画布：转型实践指南》，助力酒店经营者从“净零影响”迈向“净正面效益”，为社群与宾客创造持久价值。该指南由行业关键伙伴共同制定，为酒店管理者提供了清晰的方法论，以识别净正向贡献并将其转化为具体行动。

本指南汲取再生型待客之道的两大核心理念：
再生思维转变：培育领导者对生态与社会责任的深刻认知；以及**生态系统路径**：整合自然环境与人文关系以驱动系统性变革。

该模型的关键要素包括：关注所在地社会与自然生态系统的**地域智慧**，以及聚焦于重塑主客互动关系的**人文智慧**。这一整体性方法适用于各类规模与形态的酒店及泛服务业企业，表明再生不仅是理想，更是一种经济可行、战略可控、使命驱动的商业模式，能够创造长期的积极影响。

本研究领衔专家、《再生型待客之道：变革型酒店及泛服务业领导者战略》（由出版社Edgar-Elgar-Publishing出版）一书合著者Inversini博士谈道，“再生型待客之道体现了一种对现实与生态系统更广泛的责任，它既**根植于地域**，又以**人为本**。”

再生理念为何对酒店及泛服务业至关重要

酒店及泛服务业因其对“人”与“地域”的深度依存关系，在引领这场变革中具有独特优势。不同于其他行业，酒店与度假村无法“外包”其环境：海滨酒店与海岸生态健康休戚与共，山居木屋与周边生态系统相互依存，而城市酒店则深深嵌入周边社群的社会肌理。

再生理念能赋予酒店更强的运营韧性，推动酒店重新审视供应链、社群关系及环境依存度。这些转变不仅能降低风险、塑造品牌差异化优势，更将开启超越成本管控的新价值源泉。

酒店及泛服务业与旅游业已涌现诸多再生实践范例。墨西哥Playa-Viva豪华生态度假村不仅修复海岸生态系统，还投资了当地健康与教育；加拿大Fogo-Island-Inn酒店将生态守护与宾客参与完美融合；巴西Ibiti-Projeto项目（项目代表曾作为再生经济主题演讲嘉宾出席2025年EHL开放创新峰会），已将6000公顷退化区域改造为生物多样性保护区，并成功重建原物种生态系统。

“再生型待客之道体现了一种对现实与生态系统更广泛的责任，它既根植于地域，又以人为本。”

”



Alessandro Inversini博士
EHL教授，数字传播、数字营销、电子旅游（e-tourism）、数字化转型、移动营销及再生经济学领域专家

在瑞士，《再生型待客之道画布：转型实践指南》已在日内瓦万豪酒店、日内瓦希尔顿酒店、克莱恩·蒙塔纳六善酒店及Hôtel-des Horlogers等业界先锋中完成实践验证。各酒店结合当地特色探索再生路径，共同印证该方法的实用性与适应性。

日内瓦万豪酒店总经理Pierre-Henri Perrin表示，“对我们而言，再生型待客之道已超越可持续范畴。它意味着主动为环境、社群及宾客福祉创造正向影响。在日内瓦万豪酒店，我们正重新构想待客之道，致力于修复、滋养并再生我们身处的生态系统，同时确保为宾客提供富有意义与责任感的旅行体验。”

该酒店已落地多项再生实践：通过本地采购以及与区域生产商合作，既支撑周边社群发展又缩短供应链距离；推行减废计划，并与同样秉持“更负责任未来”理念的本地伙伴展开深度协作。

“我们相信，再生型待客之道将成为酒店及泛服务业的决定性支柱，” Perrin补充道，“宾客将愈发期待酒店不仅减少损害，更要积极促进当地生态与社群再生。未来，这将体现为与本地生产者的深度协作、更透明的影响力评估，以及将康养、文化与自然融入宾客体验核心。”

位于瑞士克莱恩·蒙塔纳的六善酒店也是再生实践的先行者，自1995年创立以来，酒店始终将康养理念与再生设计作为品牌核心。“再生型待客之道是一场永无止境的远征，而非终点，” 克莱恩·蒙塔纳六善酒店可持续发展总监Dominic Paul Dubois表示。

坐落于汝拉山谷的Hôtel-des-Horlogers，长期践行可持续发展理念与环保责任标准，如今更将再生理念融入品牌基因。“再生性已刻入我们酒店的DNA。正如本地制表匠人，我们始终行胜于言。这一过程要求我们以完整、全局的视角，审视那些惯常被忽略的维度，” Hôtel-des Horlogers总经理André Cheminade表示。

为深化该领域认知，EHL正与贝鲁特美国大学自然保护中心联合开展黎巴嫩乡村研究项目，深入探索再生型待客之道在推动自然与社会系统再生中的角色，以及数字技术在其中的支撑作用。



Pierre-Henri Perrin
日内瓦万豪酒店总经理



Dominic Paul Dubois
克莱恩·蒙塔纳六善酒店可持续发展总监



André Cheminade
Hôtel des Horlogers总经理

前行之路

尽管再生型待客之道仍处发展初期，且部分酒店经营者持审慎态度。其中一大挑战在于缺乏统一的衡量标准，使得成效难以量化。全球可持续旅游委员会（GSTC）、联合国教科文组织可持续旅游承诺、世界可持续酒店业联盟及福布斯旅游指南等机构，正积极构建更清晰的框架与最佳实践，以增强可持续声明的可验证性。在再生指标尚未严格界定的当下，业界专家普遍认同真正的影响力应体现在社群生态系统层面，例如通过社群福祉、自然修复与本地文化保护等维度进行衡量。

正如EHL教授Inversini博士所言：“再生不是固定配方，而是倾听、尝试、失败与学习的过程。再生实践者不应执着于建立新指标或标准尺度，因为这里没有清单可循，也没有放之四海皆准的标准。再生的成效将由酒店员工与宾客亲身感知——因其本质是系统化却根植本地的变革，其涟漪效应终将体现于本地生态系统的修复、强化与协同演进。”

另一重挑战在于再生的高度情境依赖性，这意味着不存在两种完全相同的再生路径。城市商务酒店的成功经验未必适用于山居木屋，但正是这种特性为创新开辟了空间。再生型待客之道摒弃了自上而下的标准化方案，转而深度响应本地需求，从而有效规避“一刀切”模式带来的潜在陷阱。

EHL国际咨询委员会（IAB）成员，中国上海综合性酒店旅游企业——锦江国际集团副总裁Vivian Wei Zhou，高度认同再生经济的巨大潜力，并坚信其关乎人类未来的长远发展。“我相信，再生经济已超越传统可持续范畴，它警醒我们珍视地球及其馈赠的一切资源。”但她同时强调，必须让再生理念契合营利性企业逻辑，并采取协作推进路径，“这是一项需要所有利益相关者协调推

进的全局性事业，必须统筹技术实施、商业模式、政策框架与跨境合规等多重维度。”

需要特别明确的是，再生型待客之道不应被视作新的可持续发展标准或现有实践的替代品，而应被视为与自然、社群及人类文明更深度契合的进阶路径。“再生型待客之道不是可持续发展的替代方案，而是方式上的根本转变，”Inversini博士补充道。归根结底，再生型待客之道在于回归“人”与“地域”——创建繁荣社群、韧性生态，以及主客共荣的体验模式。当商业成功与生态社会再生形成同频共振，酒店及泛服务业将真正铸就多维、持久且深入人心的正向影响力。

“
我相信，再生经济已超越传统可持续范畴，它警醒我们珍视地球及其馈赠的一切资源。
”



Vivian Wei Zhou
EHL国际咨询委员会（IAB）成员，锦江国际集团副总裁

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总监

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Open AI 语言模型ChatGPT

EHL概览

酒店及泛服务业、商业管理教育集团
全球领先的酒店及泛服务业教育、商业教育机构



4,000+

名学生，来自125个国家和地区



3

大校区，分别位于瑞士洛桑、
瑞士帕苏格和新加坡



3

个区域办事处，分别位于中国（北
京、上海）及印度（哈里亚纳邦）



35,000+

名杰出校友，遍布于
全球150多个国家和地区



800+

名教职工提供全方位支持



20+

初创企业（由创新中心培育）



57

家获扶持初创公司与成长型企业



5

大研究所



1

间米其林餐厅——Berceau Des Sens
（位于EHL洛桑校区的米其林一星餐厅）

关于EHL

EHL(前身为：洛桑酒店管理学院)，始建于1893年，是全球领先的酒店及泛服务业教育、商业教育机构，在瑞士和新加坡设有三大校区，拥有来自120多个国家和地区的4,000多名学生。EHL致力于培养学生心智、技能与品德的全面发展，不断为酒店业、泛服务业，以及更广泛的体验导向型行业培养自信、多元且具备韧性的卓越领导者。

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